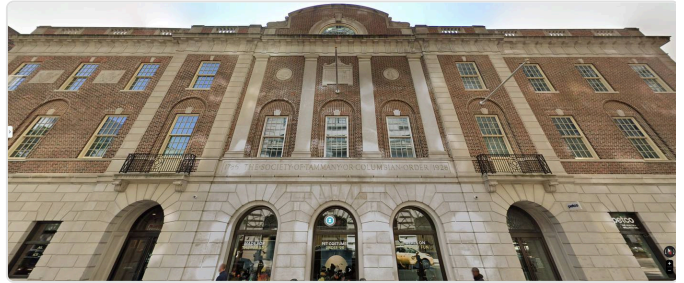


THE BUILDING TODAY



The Union Square front

The pediment, the Doric portico and the first-floor balcony — Petco at the base today.



1786 · 1928

The Society of Tammany or Columbian Order, cut into the limestone band above the arcade.



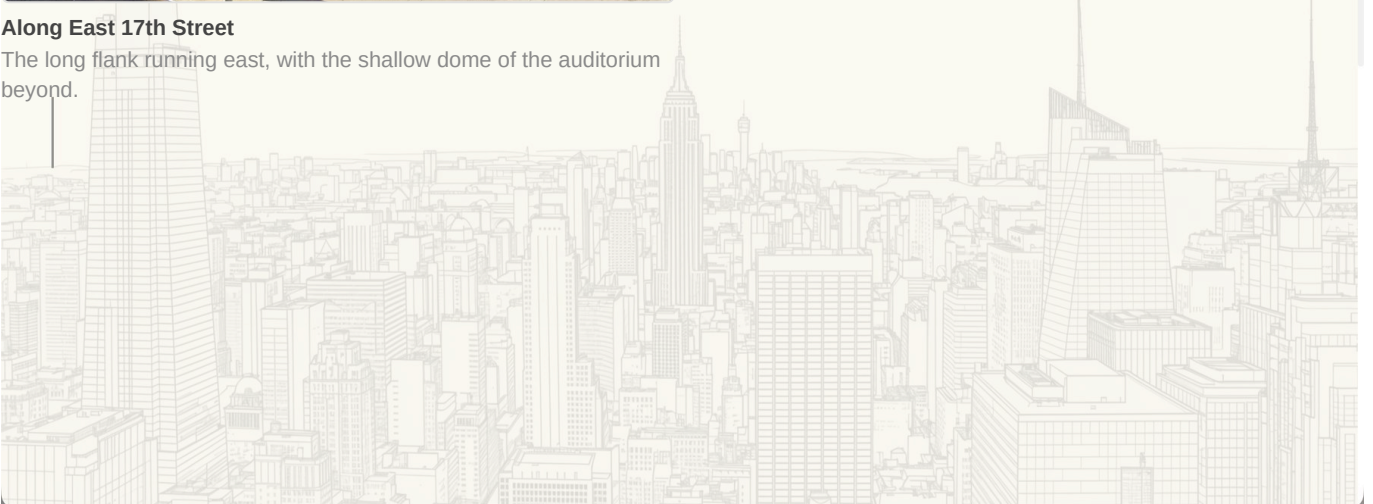
Along East 17th Street

The long flank running east, with the shallow dome of the auditorium beyond.



The 17th Street elevation

Terra-cotta panels, blind arches and the domed end of the old meeting hall.





Between tenants

The Union Square front during the Reading International years, retail space standing empty.

44 Union Square East

44 Union Square East: A Corner Reborn Through Four Centuries

Every previously italicized phrase is highlighted and colour-coded by source. Where the source page is on file, clicking the highlight opens the scan.

COLOUR KEY — ONE COLOUR PER SOURCE · sources with a page scan are marked ♪

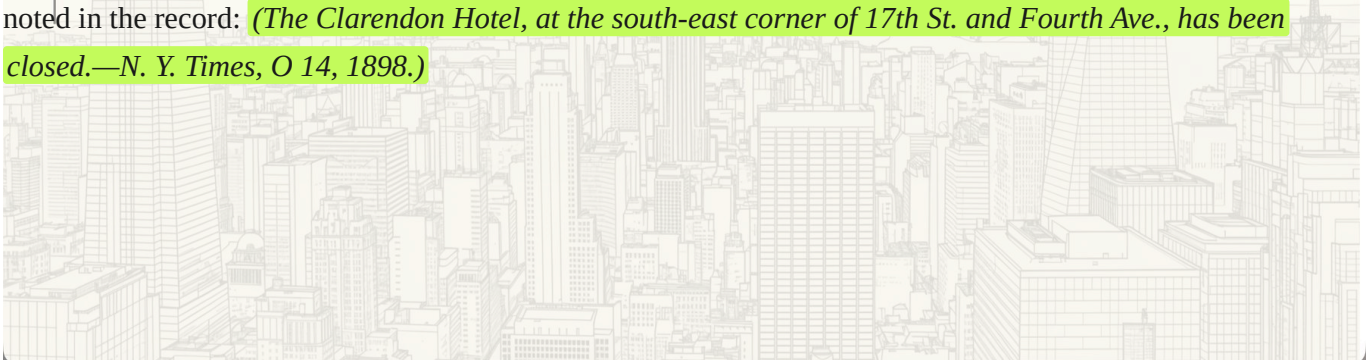
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ■ Sackersdorff, <i>1815 Blue Book</i>, 1815 p. 4 (1) ♪ ■ Dripps, <i>1867 Dripps Plan</i>, 1867 p. 7 (1) ♪ ■ Bromley, <i>1897 Bromleys Atlas</i>, 1897 p. 19 (1) ♪ ■ Stokes, <i>The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Five</i>, 1926 p. 2035 (1) ♪ ■ Dolkart, <i>Gramercy</i>, 1996 p. 78 (4) ♪ ■ Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i>, 2010 p. 1278 (4) ♪ ■ LPC, <i>Union Square</i>, 1929 p. 1 (1) ♪ ■ Hennessy, <i>Walking Broadway</i>, 2020 p. 95 (4) ♪ ■ Bromley, <i>1930 Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan</i>, 1930 p. 54 (1) ♪ ■ Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i>, 2003 p. 250 (5) ♪ ■ Lawliss, <i>The New York Theatre Sourcebook</i>, 1981 p. 183 (3) ♪ ■ Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i>, 2003 p. 64 (4) ♪ ■ Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i>, 1995 p. 1 (6) ♪ ■ Wilson, <i>New York in Literature</i>, 1947 p. 128 (1) ♪ | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ■ Perris, <i>1853 Perris Maps</i>, 1853 p. 52 (1) ♪ ■ Robinson, <i>1885 Robinsons Atlas</i>, 1885 p. 15 (1) ♪ ■ G. W. Bromley & Co., <i>1916 Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan</i>, 1916 p. 55 (1) ♪ ■ Ferrara, <i>A Guide to Gangsters</i>, 2009 p. 182 (1) ♪ ■ Trager, <i>Park Avenue</i>, 1990 p. 185 (2) ♪ ■ Unknown Author, <i>Landmarks Preservation Commission</i>, n.d. p. 1 (1) ♪ ■ Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i>, 2016 p. 679 (5) ♪ ■ Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i>, 1932 pp. 23, 198 (8) ♪ ■ Reynolds, <i>Monuments and Masterpieces</i>, 1988 p. 187 (2) ♪ ■ Bromley, <i>1955 Manhattan Land Book</i>, 1955 p. 44 (1) ♪ ■ Millman, <i>Seats</i>, 1998 p. 120 (1) ♪ ■ Grader, <i>The Cheap Bastards Guide to NYC</i>, 2002 p. 16 (1) ♪ ■ Holmes, <i>100 New Yorker</i>, 2004 p. 37 (1) ♪ ■ Brainard, <i>Who's Who In New York City and State</i>, 1911 p. 378 (1) ♪ |
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BEFORE THE WIGWAM: THE VACANT PLOT AND THE FIRST DWELLINGS

Long before this corner acquired its notoriety, it lay all but untouched. The earliest surviving record reveals a parcel of ground still awaiting its destiny, for *(In the 1815 Blue Book, on 44 Union Square East, there is reference to 0 structures.)* Within a generation, gracious residences had taken root upon the land, as *(In the 1853 Perris Maps, on 44 Union Square East, there is reference to 4 structures; Brick or Stone dwellings first class (slate or metal roof & coped) with Framed Extension and skylights lighting the top floor only, Brick or Stone dwellings first class (slate or metal roof & coped) with Framed Extension and skylights lighting the top floor only, Brick or Stone dwellings first class (slate or metal roof & coped) with Framed Extension and skylights lighting the top floor only, Brick or Stone dwellings first class (slate or metal roof & coped) with Framed Extension.)* By the years following the Civil War, a quartet of buildings crowded the site, for *(In the 1867 Dripps Plan, on 44 Union Square East, there is reference to 4 structures; Building, Building, Building, Building.)*

THE WESTMORELAND AND THE AGE OF HOTELS

As the district matured into a fashionable quarter, a hotel came to dominate the corner. *(In the 1885 Robinsons Atlas, on 44 Union Square East, there is written 'West Moreland Hotel' as well as reference to 2 Structures; Brick building, Brick building.)* This hostelry endured through the century's twilight, when *(In the 1897 Bromleys Atlas, on 44 Union Square East, there is written 'West Moreland Hotel' as well as reference to 3 Structures; 5 Story Brick building, 7 Story Brick building, 3 Story Brick building with Basement.)* Its name persisted, though in slightly altered form, into the new century, for *(In the 1916 Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan, on 44 Union Square East, there is written 'Westmoreland' as well as reference to 3 Structures; 5 Story Brick building with Store, 7 Story Brick building with Store and Elevator, 3 Story Brick building with Basement and Store.)* A neighboring establishment met its end during these same years, its passing dutifully noted in the record: *(The Clarendon Hotel, at the south-east corner of 17th St. and Fourth Ave., has been closed.—N. Y. Times, O 14, 1898.)*



THE ARRIVAL OF TAMMANY HALL

The edifice destined to define this corner arose out of the restless wanderings of a formidable political dynasty. Long entrenched elsewhere in the city, the machine drifted northward across the decades, for *(Tammany Hall's first headquarters were located downtown near city hall; they moved into a building on this site in 1867. Tammany remained here until 1928, when it sold the building to Consolidated Gas and moved to its third and final location, at Street (the present-day New York Film Academy building), where it only lasted a couple of years before finally going out of business. Tammany Hall was a notoriously corrupt political organization with very close ties to the criminal underworld of the Lower East Side.)* The blueprint for its final home crystallized at the close of the 1920s, when *(Late in 1927, the Society of Tammany sold its headquarters on East 14th Street and announced the construction of a new Tammany Hall. Plans for the new building were made public in January 1928.)* As another chronicler recounts the migration, *(Tammany Hall, whose "Wigwam" had stood for decades in 14th Street and whose Democratic leaders still ruled New York, moved in 1928 into a new marble building at 100 East 17th Street, corner of Fourth Avenue.)*

The new hall rose to completion at the very summit of the organization's power and prestige. *(Tammany Hall reached its zenith in 1928. Smith was a powerful and widely respected governor; Walker was an extraordinarily popular mayor, and George W. Olvany, a college graduate, was the boss. A new building was completed in 1929 in Union Square at 17th Street, and during this period even reformers had few criticisms of Tammany Hall.)* More tersely, one record simply affirms that it *(Was built in 1929.)*

THE BUILDING ITSELF: ARCHITECTURE AND SYMBOLISM

The commission fell to distinguished architects, and the chosen idiom bore a meaning far weightier than mere ornament. *(On the southeast corner of East 17th Street and Union Square East, at 100-102 East 17th Street, stands the second of the district's institutional buildings. Tammany Hall, once the headquarters of New York City's Democratic Party political machine.)* The intentions animating the design were made plain from the outset, for *(The building, designed by Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, was to be a Colonial Revival structure built of red Harvard brick with granite trim (limestone was later substituted). The Real Estate Record described the design as "a dignified architectural treatment, one of the chief motifs of which are the severe Colonial columns in the centers of the Union Square and the Seventeenth-street facades which recall the days of early American architecture.")*

The symbolic calculation behind the style was anything but incidental, for *(The Colonial Revival was undoubtedly chosen not only because it was reminiscent of the architecture of the early republic, but also because it symbolized the government established during that period. The Society of Tammany was attempting to associate itself with the ideals of early American democracy: in fact, the Union Square facade bears a*

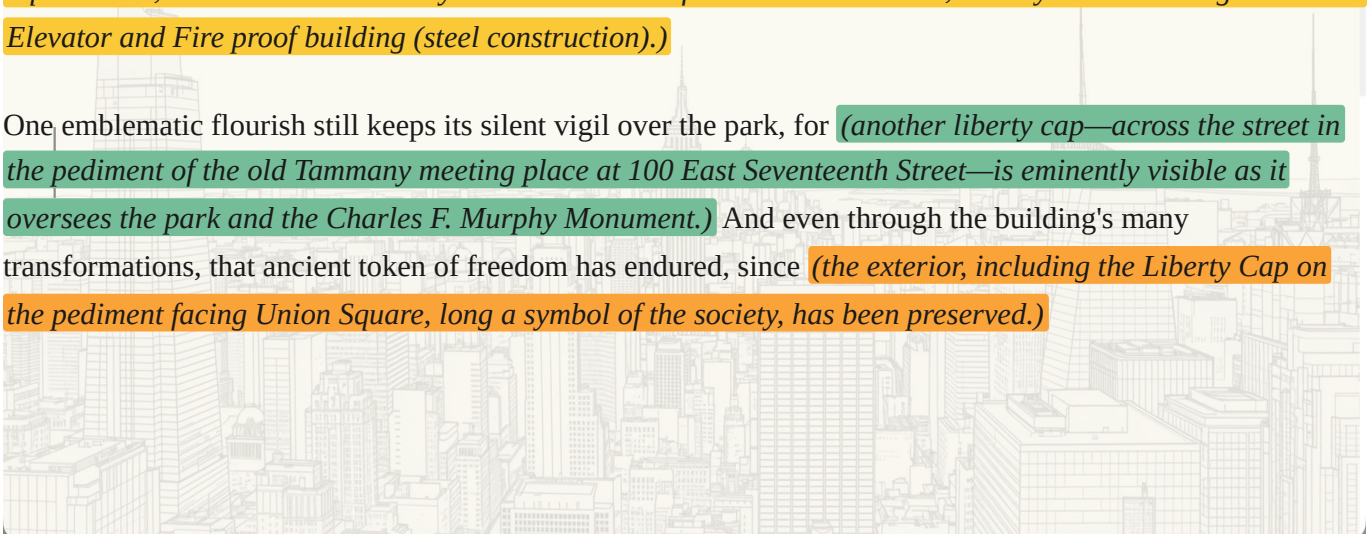
striking resemblance to the original Federal Hall, where George Washington took the oath of office as the first President of the United States. By choosing the Colonial Revival style, with all that it symbolized, Tammany may have been attempting to create the image of a truly democratic force to counter the accusations that it was a corrupt political machine.)

The precise vocabulary of its architecture has been catalogued with meticulous exactitude: (*_neo-Georgian, Contemporary, _Rusticated Limestone, <Façade Material> _Clinker Brick, Limestone, Terra Cotta, _Molded Arched Surround, Gothic Arched Transom, _2nd fl. Balcony, Flat Arch Brick Lintels, Stone Keystones, Projecting Sills, Window Panes: [8/8], Window Panes: [12/12], _Doric Pilasters, Doric Columns, Pedimented Portico, Double Height Pilasters, Stone Console Brackets, Quoins, Sculptural Relief Tablet, Rondels, _Doric Entablature, Garlands, Roundel, Balustrade, Hipped Roof, Brick/ Stone Parapet, Construction: Hipped Roof Changing to Shell Dome.*)

An official designation record contemplates the same façade with comparable admiration: (*This distinguished neo-Georgian facade, with its rusticated stone base, double-height pilasters, and sculptural reliefs in terra cotta and limestone, was inspired by the original Federal Hall (demolished 1812) on Wall Street, where the first President of the United States, George Washington, took his oath of office. Clad with specially molded and oversized brick laid in Flemish bond, other neo-Georgian elements of the facade, such as the blind arches that frame the multilight sash windows, the fanlight transoms, wrought iron balconies, and semicircular attic window, deliberately evoke the dignity of early American architecture.*) A later guide reiterates the same illustrious lineage: (*The Union Square facade of the building including the first-floor balcony under the portico was deliberately modelled on that of New York's original Federal Hall on Wall Street (demolished 1812) where Washington was inaugurated as our nation's first President.*)

The finished structure was heralded in its own moment, as one caption of the day proclaims: (*Image Caption: The new Tammany Hall, facing Union Square at 17th Street and 4th Avenue. Built in 1929.*) The land records of the era duly registered its arrival, for (*In the 1930 Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan, on 44 Union Square East, there is written 'Tammy Hall' as well as reference to 1 Structure; 4 Story Brick building with Store Elevator and Fire proof building (steel construction).*)

One emblematic flourish still keeps its silent vigil over the park, for (*another liberty cap—across the street in the pediment of the old Tammany meeting place at 100 East Seventeenth Street—is eminently visible as it oversees the park and the Charles F. Murphy Monument.*) And even through the building's many transformations, that ancient token of freedom has endured, since (*the exterior, including the Liberty Cap on the pediment facing Union Square, long a symbol of the society, has been preserved.*)

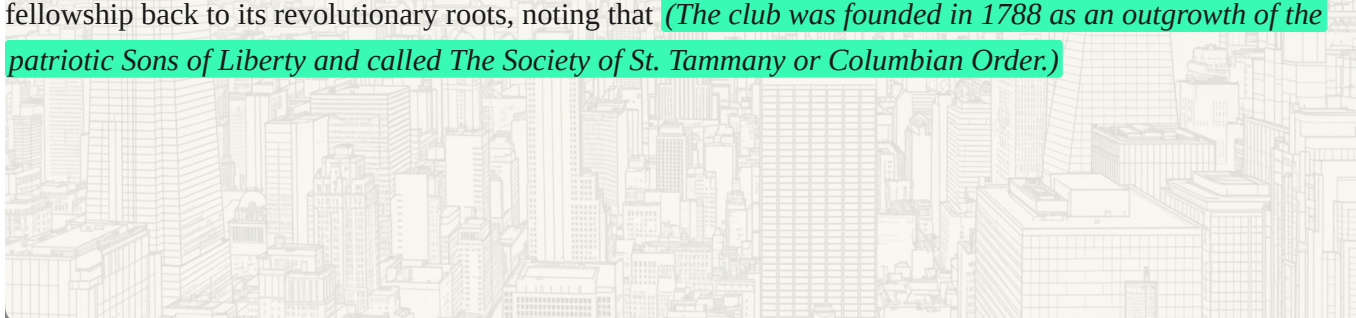


THE CHARACTER OF TAMMANY HALL

The society that raised this hall was among the most fiercely polarizing institutions ever to grace American public life. *(TAMMANY HALL!!—revered by its constituents; feared by neutrals; hated by its opponents! The New York Tammany Society was founded about 1786, and organized under a constitution in 1789 as a charitable and patriotic order. It has gradually developed into one of the most powerful political influences in the history of our nation.)* Its very name reached back into an older, mythic past, drawn as it was from *(its name from a sachem of the Delaware Indians (Tammany—one of the chiefs of the Algonquins, living on the banks of the Delaware River, who for years held undisputed sway over Eastern America) this great society, from its very organization became a dominating factor in the councils of the Democratic Party and has commanded such a power in local, state, and even national politics, that the name "Tammany" has become known world over.)*

The fervor it inspired ran to the very extremes of human sentiment, for *(Tammany Hall is the shrine at which hundreds of thousands of loyal democrats worship, and point with pride to its achievements. On the other hand, its opponents damn Tammany Hall as the hellish headquarters for graft, corruption, and misused power! Has any institution ever organized outside of fanatical religious circles, been so beloved or so hated; so lauded or so execrated; so eulogized or so condemned!)* Its dominion over the city was near-absolute, for *(New York politics are so intimately identified with Tammany Hall it is said that the Democratic Party in New York City is so completely controlled by this powerful organization that no nominee has even a fighting chance for victory unless endorsed by Tammany.)*

The organization's genesis and its contested legacy are elsewhere distilled with clarity: *(Tammany Hall, now a byword for municipal corruption, once dominated the City's political arena. An outgrowth of the eighteenth-century Tammany Society, Tammany Hall quickly became affiliated with the newly formed Democratic Party, promoting public education, universal suffrage for white males, and helping to abolish debtors' prisons; as well as providing support for newly arrived Irish, French, and German immigrants. By the mid-nineteenth century, Tammany was firmly in charge of the municipal government, and under the leadership of the now infamous "Boss" William Tweed.)* It was precisely a bid at reinvention and rehabilitation that gave rise to this very building, since *(His fall, and the emergence of a "New Tammany" in the 1920s, refashioned as a "good government" organization, has been identified by some as the impetus for the construction of this New Tammany Hall, the only surviving headquarters building of Tammany.)* Yet another account traces the fellowship back to its revolutionary roots, noting that *(The club was founded in 1788 as an outgrowth of the patriotic Sons of Liberty and called The Society of St. Tammany or Columbian Order.)*



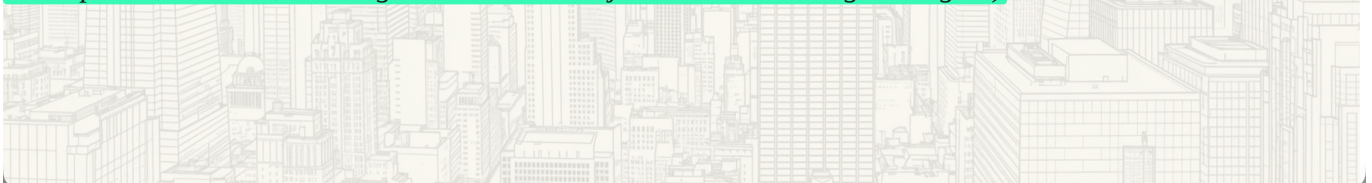
THE FALL AND THE SALE

The machine's descent followed hard upon the completion of its grandest monument. *(But the organizations fortunes soon changed. Investigations of civic corruption by Samuel Seabury led to Walker's resignation in 1932.)* The reverberations of scandal reshaped the whole political landscape, for *(John F. Curry, Olvany's successor, sought to block Franklin D. Roosevelt's presidential nomination, allowing Flynn, no longer an ally of Tammany Hall, to become the strongest link between the Democratic White House and the city. In 1933 Mayor John P. O'Brien, the incumbent and a loyalist chosen by Curry, finished last in a three-way mayoral election won by Fiorello H. La Guardia, who led a coalition opposed to Tammany Hall that remained in place for 12 years.)* The essence of that undoing is captured succinctly in the observation that *(By the early 1930s the extent of the society's graft and corruption was widely recognized, and Tammany Mayor James J. Walker was forced to resign in 1932.)*

There followed the loss of the building itself, a downfall as material as it was symbolic, for *(Unable to meet mortgage payments, the sachems sold their building to Local 91 of the International Ladies' Garment Workers' Union in 1943. By the time the Democrats recaptured the mayoralty in 1945, Tammany Hall had virtually ceased to exist, although politicians bred in the organization continued to flourish into the 1950s and beyond.)* By mid-century, the ledgers themselves bore witness to the transformation, for *(In the 1955 Manhattan Land Book, on 44 Union Square East, there is reference to 1 Structure; 4 Story Brick or Stone or Concrete building with Elevator and Fire proof building (steel construction).)*

FROM UNION HALL TO THEATRE AND FILM ACADEMY

The building's later chapters interwove the causes of organized labor with the enchantments of the stage. Reflecting upon this melancholy yet fitting reinvention, one observer described how *(the trim neo-Federal-style brick-and-limestone building, No. 100 East 17th Street (Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, 1929), was the "final resting place" of Tammany Hall, the Democratic political machine that held the city in a corrupt stranglehold for almost two centuries.)* A preservationist mused upon its abiding significance, observing that *("the building is such a great example of Colonial Revival, of a time when a group tried to burnish its crooked reputation by linking itself to early American ideals," adding, "the history of Tammany Hall, shabby as it is, is also a big part of our past, and this building is the sole physical remnant of that.")* There even arose a mischievous proposal for its future, for *(While awaiting the city's decision on landmark designation, it was suggested that the Tammany Hall building be converted into a "Museum of Political Corruption"; however, one wag observed that "it just wouldn't be large enough!")*



The building passed through many hands and served many masters across the decades that followed. *(In 1929, when the building was completed, Tammany had again fallen out of favor, and by 1943, the Society sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies Garment Workers Union, which occupied it until 1984. That year, the Local entered into a lease agreement with the Roundabout Theatre, which renovated and occupied the building's auditorium until 1991, when it moved to 45th Street. Local 91 subsequently leased the auditorium to producer Raymond L. Gaspard, and then to the owners of Minetta Lane Theatre. In 1994, the Local began leasing portions of the building not occupied by the theater to the New York Film Academy; in 2001, the entire building was sold to Liberty Theatres and four years later the air rights were conveyed to US Development LLC.)* A parallel account renders its theatrical rebirth in gentler strokes: *(By 1943, unable to meet its mortgage payments, Tammany sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies Garment Workers Union. In 2001, they, in turn, sold it to Liberty Theaters, who remodeled the union's former meeting hall—once called the Roosevelt Auditorium—into the present Union Square Theater. The building is also home to the New York Film Academy, a noted school for filmmakers.)* A further summary confirms this arc of stewardship, noting that *(A decade later the society sold its meeting hall to the International Ladies Garment Workers Union, and it became a major center for union activity, in 1984 the Roundabout Theater Company took over for a decade before heading uptown. The building is now being converted to office and retail use.)* Its tenure under the union's banner was recorded thus: *(In recent years it has housed the International Ladies Garment Workers Union Local 99-105, and its 499-seat auditorium has been used by the Roundabout Theater Company, a group with 20,000 subscribers.)*

THE ROUNDABOUT THEATRE COMPANY

The building's theatrical epoch commenced with an audacious act of conversion. Situated at *(100 East 17th Street at Park Avenue South, Box Office: 420-1883, Seating: 499 (Orchestra 358; Mezzanine, 141), Handicapped: Semi-accessible)*, the company forged a reputation of considerable distinction, for *(Since its founding in 1965 Artistic Director Gene Feist has built the Roundabout into one of the major nonprofit theatrical institutions in the country. A number of well-known actors got their New York start here, including Amanda Plummer, David Dukes, B. D. Wong, Kate Burton, Danny Glover, and Jerry Zaks.)* The reimagining of the space itself was a remarkable feat of transformation, since *(In 1984 the Roundabout converted a 1,000-seat auditorium in the old Tammany Hall into an intimate 500-seat theatre.)*

THE UNION SQUARE THEATRE

Under its subsequent name, the venue flourished as a bustling Off Broadway house. Located plainly at *(100 East 17th Street, New York, NY 10003)*, it accrued a spectral folklore all its own, for *(The present Union Square Theatre, according to a New York Times article, was reportedly haunted by a phantom that lived in a*

crawl space and had eyes like a cat that glowed in the dark. Windows and a chandelier once started making a racket on their own, and did not quit until the maintenance man demanded that whoever - or whatever - knock it off so he could get some sleep. And the sounds stopped.) As a theatre, it was esteemed as (A large Off Broadway house that has played host to such shows as Wit, The Laramie Project, BatBoy, and others. Call one to three weeks in advance.) Its programming in the mid-1990s boasted productions of genuine renown, among them: (Vita and Virginia: Vanessa Redgrave and Eileen Atkins star in, and Zoe Caldwell directs, this play based on the letters of Sackville West and Woolf. Union Square Theatre. 100 E 17th, 307-4100, through 2/26.) Its benefit evenings, too, summoned a glittering assembly of talent: (State of Siege, Sun: Vanessa Redgrave and Eileen Atkins host an evening of words and music to benefit the children of Sarajevo, 7. Also appearing will be Glenn Close, Stockard Channing, Mira Furlan, John Turturro, Christopher Reeve, Harvey Keitel, Simon Shaheen, Joseph Brodsky, Paul Auster, Ariel Dorfman, Susan Sontag, Tony Kushner, and Wendy Wasserstein. Union Square Theatre, 100 E 17th, 505-0700. \$) The hall likewise lent itself to purposes of oratory, for it was here that (Bly delivered a series of lectures here about her record-breaking trip around the globe.)

THE NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY

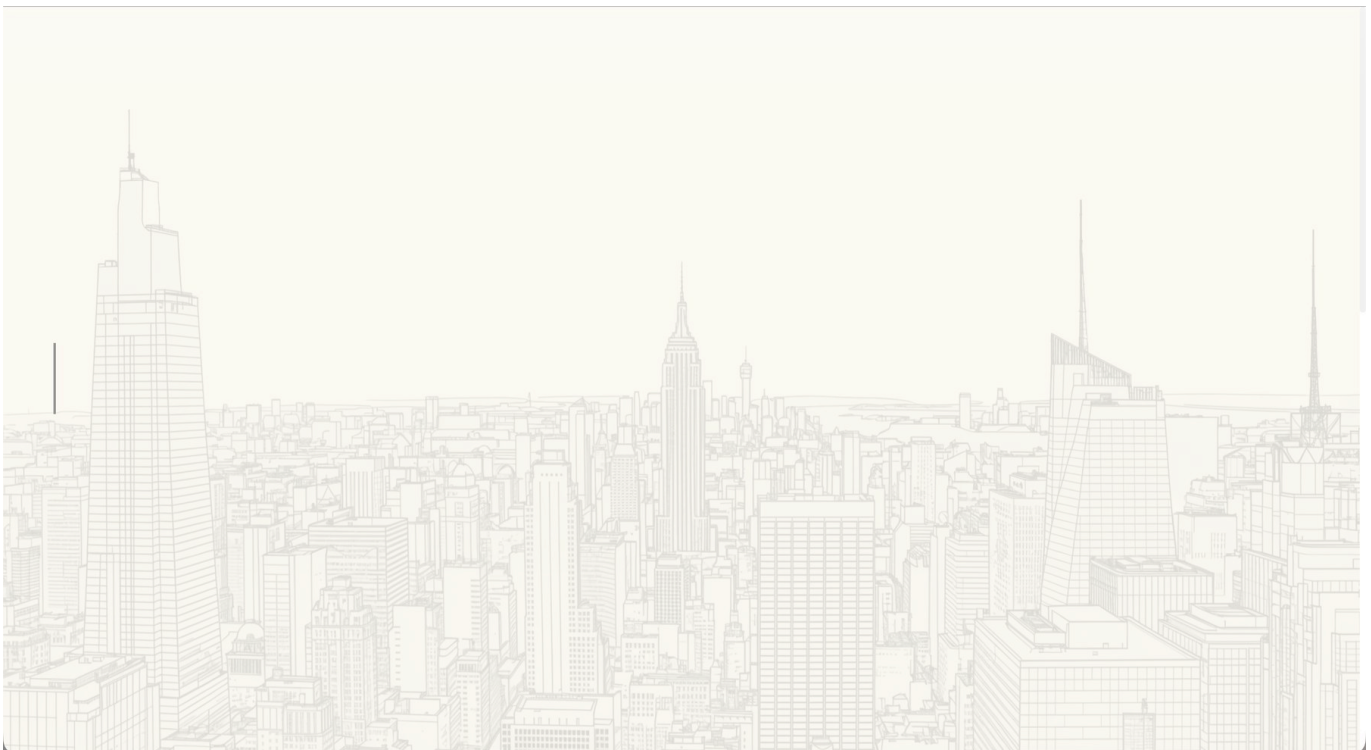
The film school emerged as one of the building's most defining modern occupants, proclaiming its presence from this address with characteristic boldness: (LEARN FILM MAKING), offering (SUMMER WORKSHOPS AT PRINCETON UNIVERSITY & NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY and) inviting aspirants to (DIRECT YOUR OWN SHORT FILMS IN OUR HANDS-ON INTENSIVE WORKSHOPS USING 16MM ARRIFLEX CAMERAS. LEARN DIRECTING, STORY, CAMERA, SOUND AND EDITING IN A TOTAL IMMERSION COURSE DESIGNED AND TAUGHT BY AWARD WINNING INSTRUCTORS.) Its address was fixed with precision, for the academy stood at (100 EAST 17TH STREET NYC 10003 TEL: 212 674-4300 FAX: 212 477-1414 FORMERLY LOCATED AT TRIBECA FILM CENTER), and its identity was distilled into a single caption: (Image Caption: NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY.)

THE SURROUNDING SQUARE AND NEIGHBORHOOD

The building presides over a park steeped in history. (Union Square was originally called Union Place in 1811. During the late nineteenth century, 14th Street was the midway point for Ladies' Mile, a walkway of swanky shops that extended from Broadway and 8th to 23rd Street.) In time, the square became a crucible of dissent, for (In the years prior to World War I, Union Square evolved into a forum for anarchists, socialists, Wobblies, and Communists, where they took to soapboxes to espouse their political leanings.) Its radical vocation deepened amid the privations of the Depression, when (The most well-known confrontation was a Depression-era workers protest of 35,000 that led to public outcry after police attacked one hundred of the protestors. Union Square was thereafter the soul of militant political movements in the City.) It remained, above all, a

sanctuary of liberty, for *(It is proper that the Independence Flagstaff stands at the center of Union Square, a park that has meant independence and freedom of speech for generations. There, especially during the 1930s, people came to speak their minds without fear of assault or arrest.)*

Close at hand rose other monuments to commercial ambition, chief among them the **(EVERETT BLDG.)** at **(45 Union Square)**, described in its particulars as **(N. W. Cor. 16th St. & 4th Ave. Cost ...\$2,500,000, 252 ft. high.....18 Floors, Rent Area... 195.000 sq. ft. Housing ...2300, Completed...1900, Owner... Everett Investing Co., Arch... Starrett & Van Vleck, Bldr...Gen. A. Fuller Co. Agent... H. Van R. Forest.)** The immediate blocks were rich, too, in literary association, for *(the last home of Jeannette L. Gilder, long editor of the Critic and arresting, if sometimes amusing, figure in the literary life of the town a generation ago, was at 100 East Seventeenth Street.)* That same journalist is elsewhere recorded with plainer economy as **(Gilder, Jeannette Leonard: born Flushing New York, October 3rd, 1849; Journalist.)**



CITATION CHART

Every highlighted quote, in order of appearance, correlated to its underlying source. The swatch matches the highlight colour in the text.

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
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21	"another liberty cap—across the street in the pediment of the old Tammany meeting place at 100 East Seventeenth Street—is eminently visible as it oversees the park and..."	 Reynolds, <i>Monuments and Masterpieces</i> , 1988, p. 187 [page scan]
22	"the exterior, including the Liberty Cap on the pediment facing Union Square, long a symbol of the society, has been preserved."	 Hennessy, <i>Walking Broadway</i> , 2020, p. 95 [page scan]
23	"TAMMANY HALL!!—revered by its constituents; feared by neutrals; hated by its opponents! The New York Tammany Society was founded about 1786, and organized under a..."	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
24	"its name from a sachem of the Delaware Indians (Tammany—one of the chiefs of the Algonquins, living on the banks of the Delaware River, who for years held undisputed..."	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
25	"Tammany Hall is the shrine at which hundreds of thousands of loyal democrats worship, and point with pride to its achievements. On the other hand, its opponents damn..."	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
26	"New York politics are so intimately identified with Tammany Hall it is said that the Democratic Party in New York City is so completely controlled by this powerful..."	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 23 [page scan]
27	"Tammany Hall, now a byword for municipal corruption, once dominated the City's political arena. An outgrowth of the eighteenth-century Tammany Society, Tammany Hall..."	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
28	"His fall, and the emergence of a 'New Tammany' in the 1920s, refashioned as a 'good government' organization, has been identified by some as the impetus for the..."	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
29	"The club was founded in 1788 as an outgrowth of the patriotic Sons of Liberty and called The Society of St. Tammany or Columbian Order."	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
30	"But the organizations fortunes soon changed. Investigations of civic corruption by Samuel Seabury led to Walker's resignation in 1932."	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
31	"John F. Curry, Olvany's successor, sought to block Franklin D. Roosevelt's presidential nomination, allowing Flynn, no longer an ally of Tammany Hall, to become the..."	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
32	"By the early 1930s the extent of the society's graft and corruption was widely recognized, and Tammany Mayor James J. Walker was forced to resign in 1932."	 Hennessy, <i>Walking Broadway</i> , 2020, p. 95 [page scan]
33	"Unable to meet mortgage payments, the sachems sold their building to Local 91 of the International Ladies' Garment Workers' Union in 1943. By the time the Democrats..."	 Jackson, <i>The Encyclopedia of New York</i> , 2010, p. 1278 [page scan]
34	"In the 1955 Manhattan Land Book, on 44 Union Square East, there is reference to 1 Structure; 4 Story Brick or Stone or Concrete building with Elevator and Fire proof..."	 Bromley, <i>1955 Manhattan Land Book</i> , 1955, p. 44 [page scan]
35	"the trim neo-Federal-style brick-and-limestone building, No. 100 East 17th Street (Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, 1929), was the "final resting..."	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
36	"the building is such a great example of Colonial Revival, of a time when a group tried to burnish its crooked reputation by linking itself to early American ideals,"..."	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
37	"While awaiting the city's decision on landmark designation, it was suggested that the Tammany Hall building be converted into a "Museum of Political Corruption";..."	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
38	"In 1929, when the building was completed, Tammany had again fallen out of favor, and by 1943, the Society sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies..."	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
39	"By 1943, unable to meet its mortgage payments, Tammany sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies Garment Workers Union. In 2001, they, in turn, sold it..."	 Wolfe, <i>New York 15 Walking Tours</i> , 2003, p. 250 [page scan]
40	"A decade later the society sold its meeting hall to the International Ladies Garment Workers Union, and it became a major center for union activity, in 1984 the..."	 Hennessy, <i>Walking Broadway</i> , 2020, p. 95 [page scan]
41	"In recent years it has housed the International Ladies Garment Workers Union Local 99-105, and its 499-seat auditorium has been used by the Roundabout Theater Company, a..."	 Trager, <i>Park Avenue</i> , 1990, p. 185 [page scan]
42	"100 East 17th Street at Park Avenue South, Box Office: 420-1883, Seating: 499 (Orchestra 358; Mezzanine, 141), Handicapped: Semi-accessible"	 Lawliss, <i>The New York Theatre Sourcebook</i> , 1981, p. 183 [page scan]
43	"Since its founding in 1965 Artistic Director Gene Feist has built the Roundabout into one of the major nonprofit theatrical institutions in the country. A number of..."	 Lawliss, <i>The New York Theatre Sourcebook</i> , 1981, p. 183 [page scan]

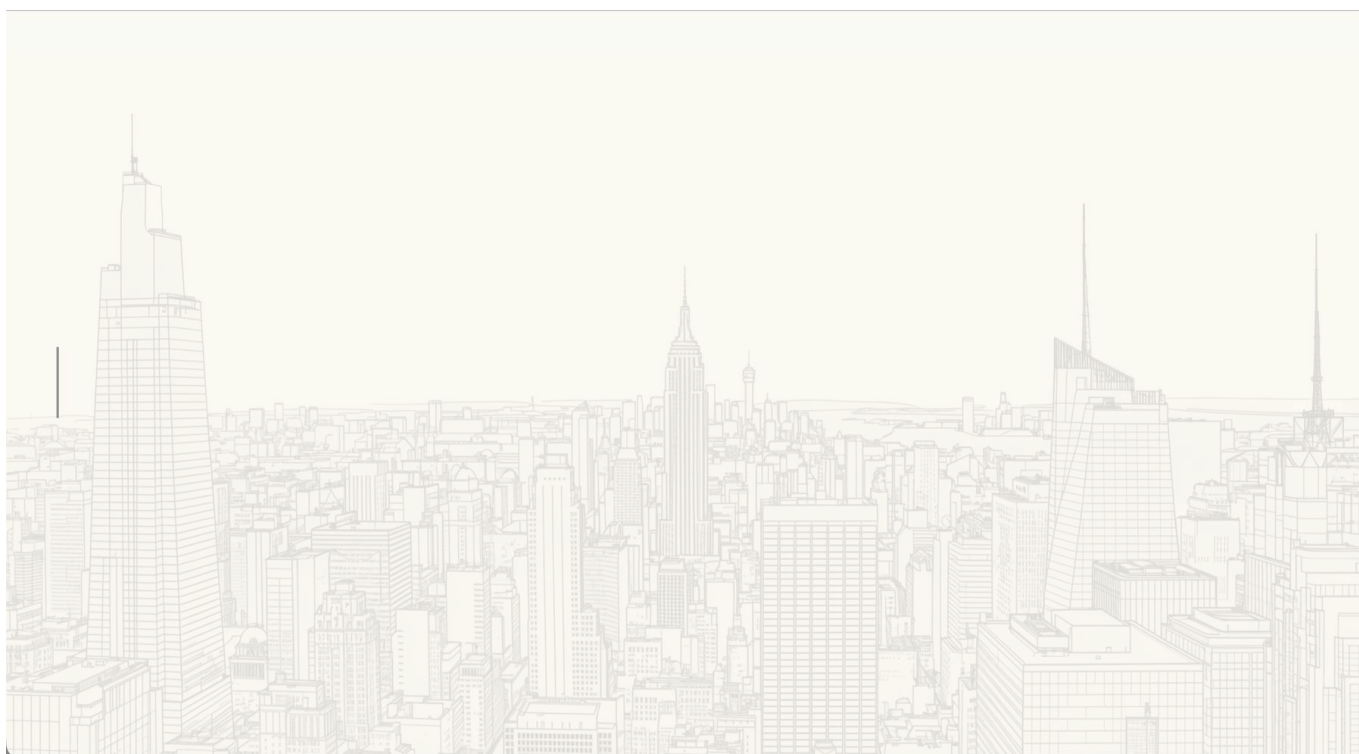
#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
44	"In 1984 the Roundabout converted a 1,000-seat auditorium in the old Tammany Hall into an intimate 500-seat theatre."	 Lawliss, <i>The New York Theatre Sourcebook</i> , 1981, p. 183 [page scan]
45	"100 East 17th Street, New York, NY 10003"	 Millman, <i>Seats</i> , 1998, p. 120 [page scan]
46	"The present Union Square Theatre, according to a New York Times article, was reportedly haunted by a phantom that lived in a crawl space and had eyes like a cat that..."	 Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
47	"A large Off Broadway house that has played host to such shows as Wit, The Laramie Project, BatBoy, and others. Call one to three weeks in advance."	 Grader, <i>The Cheap Bastards Guide to NYC</i> , 2002, p. 16 [page scan]
48	"Vita and Virginia: Vanessa Redgrave and Eileen Atkins star in, and Zoe Caldwell directs, this play based on the letters of Sackville West and Woolf. Union Square..."	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
49	"State of Siege, Sun: Vanessa Redgrave and Eileen Atkins host an evening of words and music to benefit the children of Sarajevo, 7. Also appearing will be Glenn Close,..."	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
50	"Bly delivered a series of lectures here about her record-breaking trip around the globe."	 Holmes, <i>100 New Yorker</i> , 2004, p. 37 [page scan]
51	"LEARN FILM MAKING"	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
52	"SUMMER WORKSHOPS AT PRINCETON UNIVERSITY & NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY and"	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
53	"DIRECT YOUR OWN SHORT FILMS IN OUR HANDS-ON INTENSIVE WORKSHOPS USING 16MM ARRIFLEX CAMERAS. LEARN DIRECTING, STORY, CAMERA, SOUND AND EDITING IN A TOTAL IMMERSION..."	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
54	"100 EAST 17TH STREET NYC 10003 TEL: 212 674-4300 FAX: 212 477-1414 FORMERLY LOCATED AT TRIBECA FILM CENTER"	 Village Voice, <i>Village Voice January 31st 1995</i> , 1995, p. 1 [page scan]
55	"Image Caption: NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY."	 Spielvogel, <i>The Landmarks of New York</i> , 2016, p. 679 [page scan]
56	"Union Square was originally called Union Place in 1811. During the late nineteenth century, 14th Street was the midway point for Ladies' Mile, a walkway of swanky shops..."	 Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
57	"In the years prior to World War I, Union Square evolved into a forum for anarchists, socialists, Wobblies, and Communists, where they took to soapboxes to espouse their..."	 Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
58	"The most well-known confrontation was a Depression-era workers protest of 35,000 that led to public outcry after police attacked one hundred of the protestors. Union..."	 Lanigan-Schmidt, <i>Ghosts of New York City</i> , 2003, p. 64 [page scan]
59	"It is proper that the Independence Flagstaff stands at the center of Union Square, a park that has meant independence and freedom of speech for generations. There,..."	 Reynolds, <i>Monuments and Masterpieces</i> , 1988, p. 187 [page scan]
60	"EVERETT BLDG."	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 198 [page scan]

#	Verbatim Quote (abbreviated)	Source (Author, Title, Year, Page)
61	"45 Union Square"	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 198 [page scan]
62	"N. W. Cor. 16th St. & 4th Ave. Cost ...\$2,500,000, 252 ft. high.....18 Floors, Rent Area... 195.000 sq. ft. Housing ...2300, Completed...1900, Owner... Everett..."	 Chase, <i>New York The Wonder City</i> , 1932, p. 198 [page scan]
63	"the last home of Jeannette L. Gilder, long editor of the Critic and arresting, if sometimes amusing, figure in the literary life of the town a generation ago, was at 100..."	 Wilson, <i>New York in Literature</i> , 1947, p. 128 [page scan]
64	"Gilder, Jeannette Leonard: born Flushing New York, October 3rd, 1849; Journalist."	 Brainard, <i>Who's Who In New York City and State</i> , 1911, p. 378 [page scan]



SOURCE PAGES

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Sackersdorff, 1815 *Blue Book*, 1815, p. 4

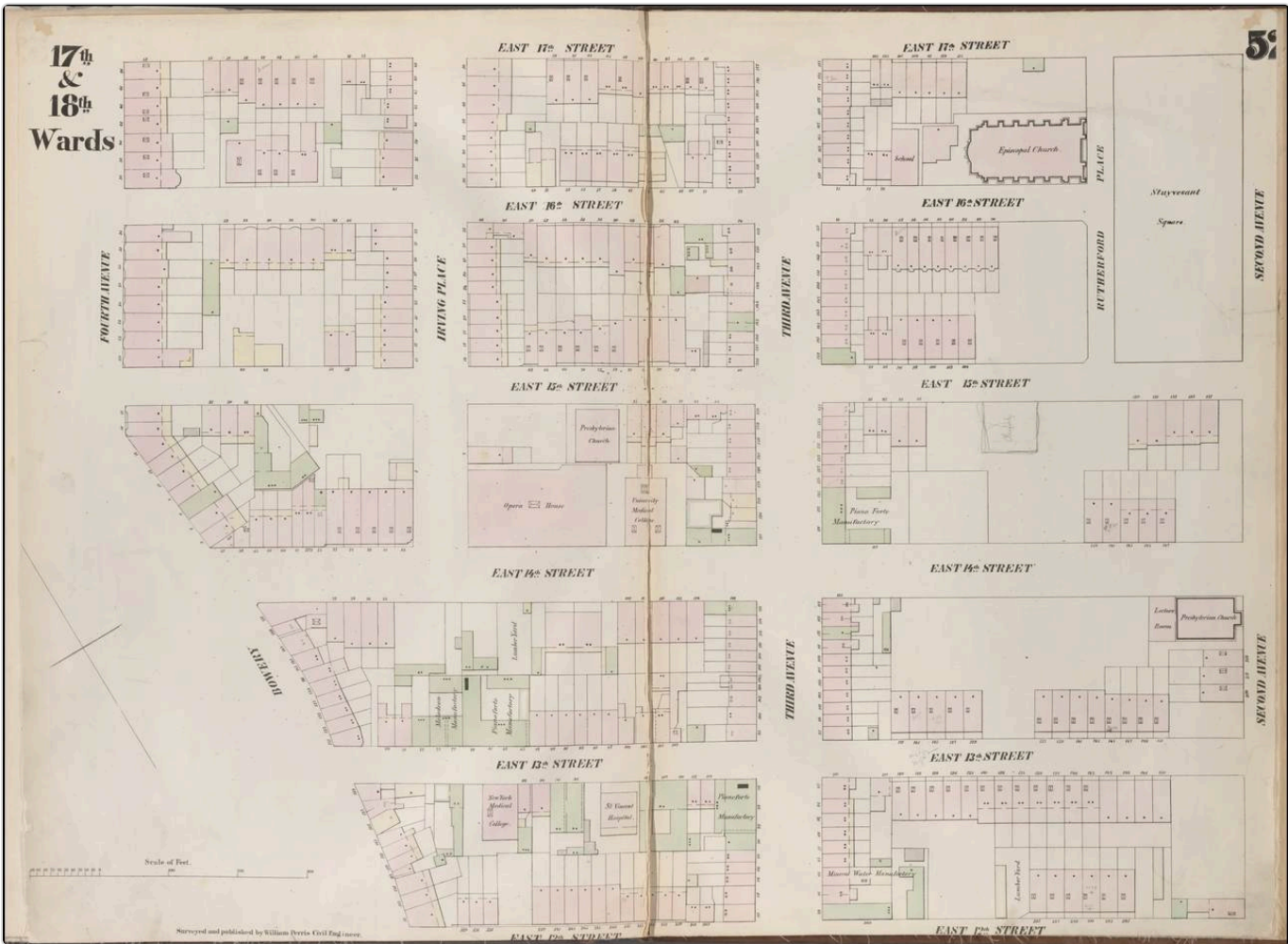
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Perris, 1853 Perris Maps, 1853, p. 52

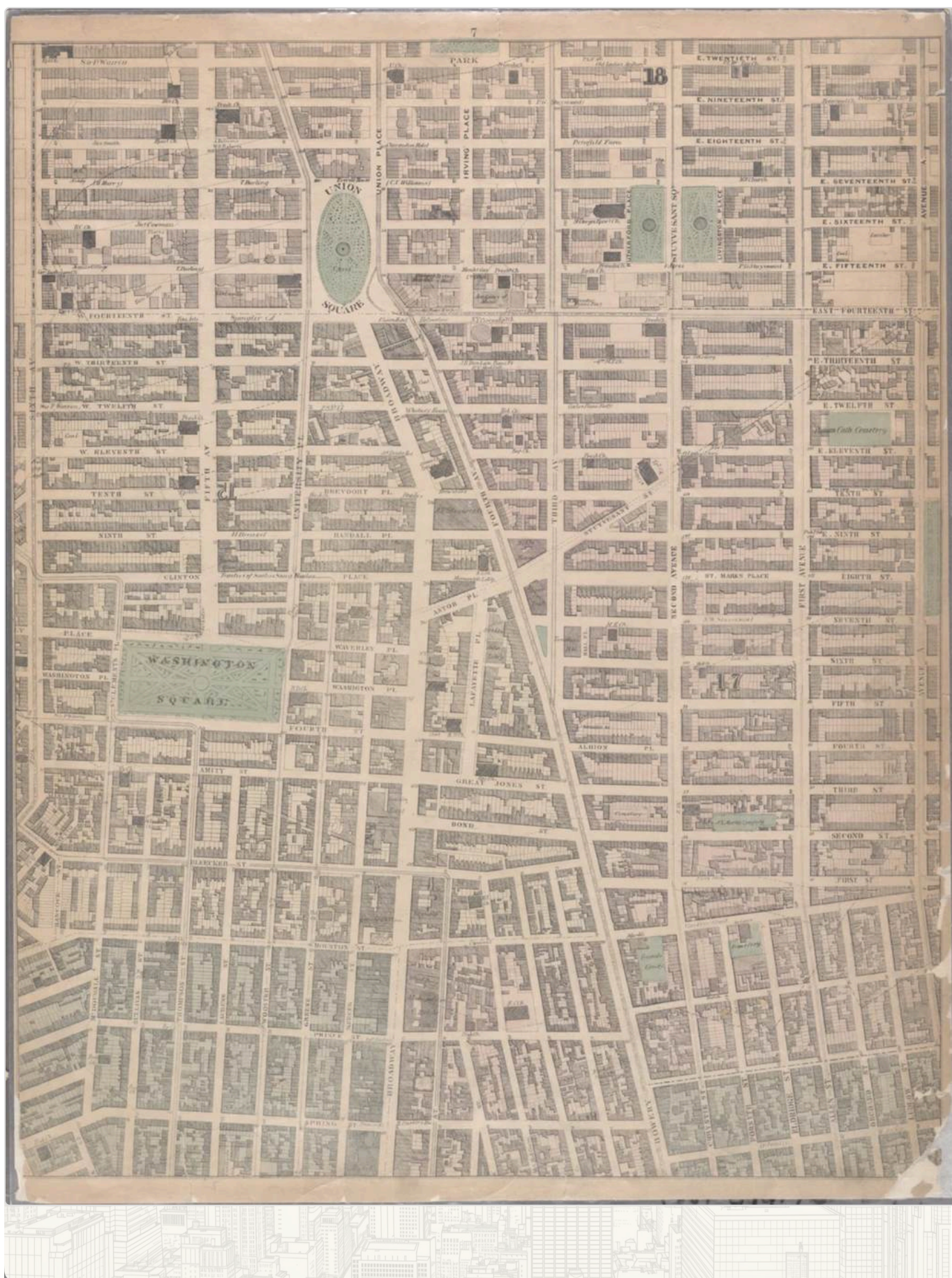
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Dripps, 1867 *Dripps Plan*, 1867, p. 7

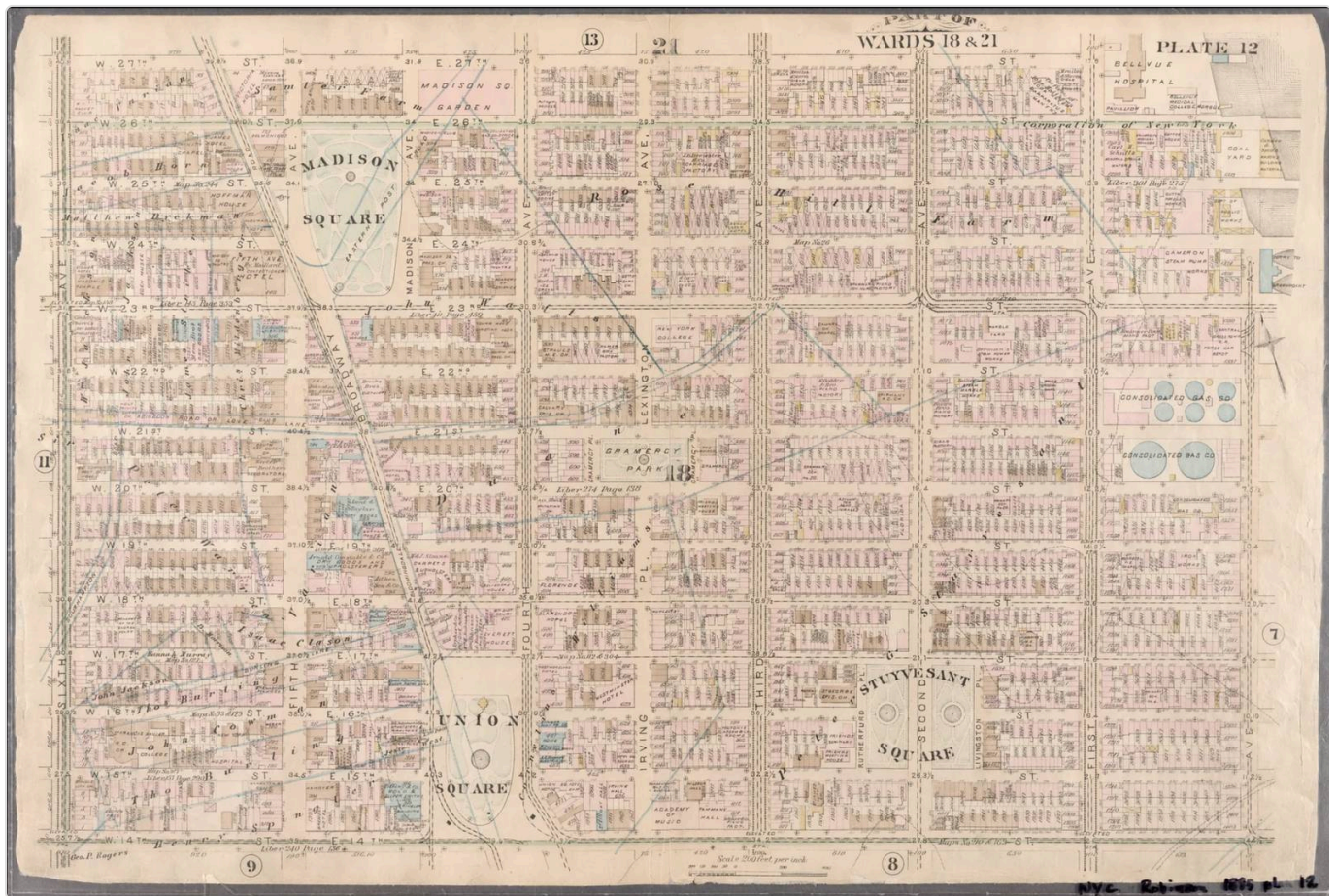
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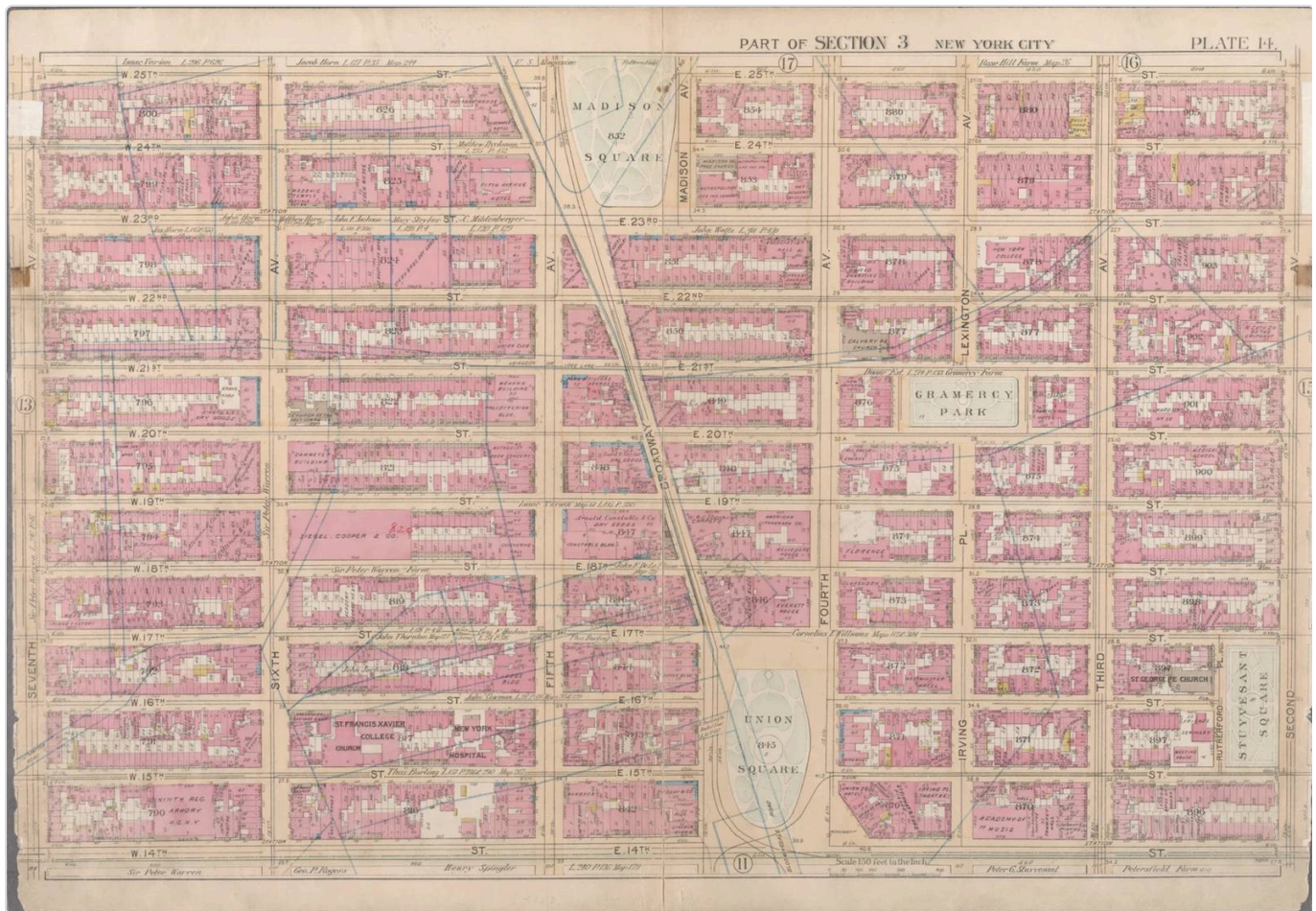
Robinson, 1885 Robinsons Atlas, 1885, p. 15

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Bromley, 1897 Bromleys Atlas, 1897, p. 19

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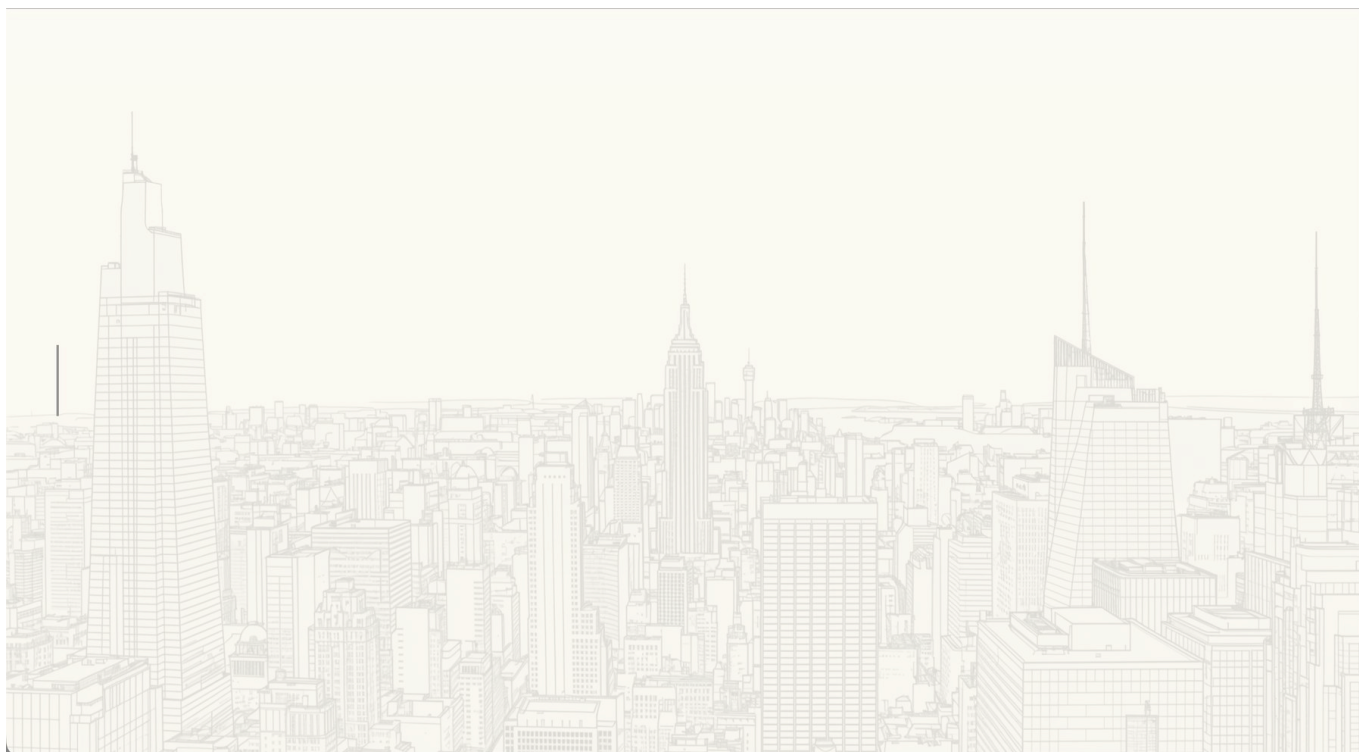
G. W. Bromley & Co., 1916 Atlas of the Borough of Manhattan, 1916, p. 55

Quotes drawn from this page: 6



Stokes, *The Iconography of Manhattan Island Volume Five*, 1926, p. 2035

Quotes drawn from this page: 7



CHRONOLOGY : THE MODERN CITY AND ISLAND : 1876-1909 2035

- 1898 The Spanish fleet under Admiral Cervera attempts to escape from Santiago Harbour and is totally destroyed by Admiral Sampson's American squadron.—*N. Y. Times*, J1 4 et seq., 1898.
- July 3 Harlem Speedway (see Mr 8, 1893, and N 2, 1896) is formally opened, though not completed. It extends from 155th St. and St. Nicholas Place to the easterly extremity of Dyckman St. along the west bank of the Harlem River. Its total cost was about \$3,050,000.—*Ann. Rep.*, Dept. of Pks. (1898); *ibid.* (1900). See also *N. Y. Times*, F 15 and Jc 26, 1898.
- 7 Pres. McKinley signs the congressional resolution annexing Hawaii to the United States.—*N. Y. Times*, J1 8, 1898.
- 14 Gen. Toral agrees to surrender Santiago to the American forces under Gen. Shafter.—*N. Y. Times*, J1 15, 1898. The formal surrender took place on July 17.—*ibid.*, J1 17, 18 et seq., 1898.
- 20 Horse-cars cease running on Sixth and Eighth Aves. below 59th St. and the work of constructing the electric lines is begun.—*N. Y. Times*, J1 18 and 21, 1898. See N 16.
- Aug. The new iron bridge across the Harlem River at Third Ave. is completed at a cost of more than \$3,000,000, and is opened to the public.—*N. Y. Times*, Ag 2, 1898; *Ann. Cyclop.* (1898), 506. See also *N. Y. Times*, F 11, 1893, and *Harper's Weekly*, XXXVIII: 115.
- 12 A peace protocol is signed at Washington by representatives of Spain and the United States, and Pres. McKinley immediately proclaims a suspension of hostilities.—*N. Y. Times*, Ag 13, 1898.
- 13 Ignorant of the armistice, Americans under Dewey capture Manila.—*N. Y. Times*, Ag 16 et seq., 1898.
- 20 Admiral Sampson's victorious squadron arrives at New York and is given an ovation.—*N. Y. Times*, Ag 21, 1898.
- Sept. Weber & Fields' Broadway Music Hall at 1215 Broadway is opened.—*N. Y. Times*, S 9, 1898.
- Oct. Automobiles "have almost ceased to be regarded as curiosities, and the embarrassment of the passengers caused by many staring eyes, is gradually wearing off."—*N. Y. Times*, O 2, 1898. See D 28.
- 3 "Cyranos de Bergerac" is produced for the first time in America, at the Garden Theatre. Richard Mansfield plays the title role.—*Sullivan, Our Times* (1926), I: 224; *Brown*, III: 528. 8/2.1
- 14 The Clarendon Hotel, at the south-east corner of 17th St. and Fourth Ave., has been closed.—*N. Y. Times*, O 14, 1898.
- Nov. Theodore Roosevelt is elected governor of New York State.—*N. Y. Times*, N 9, 1898. 1285.2
- 12 Columbia University's land and buildings on East 49th St. (once the site of the Deaf and Dumb Asylum) have been sold, and dwelling-houses are to be erected on the site.—*N. Y. Times*, N 12, 16, D 19, 1898.
- 16 The Third Ave. R. R. Co. begins to tear up Broadway from 45th to 59th St. preparatory to laying the conduits for the electrical system.—*N. Y. Times*, N 17, 1898.
- 21 Pinero's "Trelawny of the Wells" is produced for the first time in America, at the Lyceum Theatre.—*Brown*, III: 438. See also *Sullivan, Our Times* (1926), I: 230. 1187.1
- 25 Construction work on the section of Riverside Park between 120th and 129th Sts. being approved, this part is practically completed, except planting. A small part near 96th St. is left unfinished on account of a change in the original plan due to building the viaduct over that street.—*Ann. Rep.*, Dept. of Parks (1898), 18. Regarding the park, see also *Munsey's Mag.*, Oct., 1898.
- Dec. A fire, starting at the corner of Broadway and Warren St., destroys about a million's worth of property.—*N. Y. Times*, D 5, 1898.
- 10 The treaty of peace between Spain and the U. S. is signed at Paris. Spain relinquishes all claim to Cuba and cedes to the U. S. Porto Rico, Guam, and the Philippine Islands, and the U. S. agrees to pay \$20,000,000 for the ceded territory.—*Macdonald, Select Statutes of U. S. Hist.*, 1861-1898, 429-36; *N. Y. Times*, D 11, 1898.
- 28 "Horseless trucks will soon be seen in the streets of this city, and before long there may be no opportunities for usefulness left for the hard-working truck horse. The autotruck is to be the latest innovation in street traffic. The New York Autotruck Company has been incorporated with a capital of \$1,000,000 to operate the vehicles."—*N. Y. Times*, D 28, 1898.

1899

- In this year, *The Rough Riders*, by Theodore Roosevelt, appeared.—*Encyclop. Brit.*, XXIII: 711. Commenting on it, Mr. Dooley (Finley Peter Dunne) said, with characteristic humour:

"If I was him I'd call th' book 'Alone in Cuba.' " He suggested 1899 as other titles: "Th' Biography iv a Hero be Wan who Knows;" "Th' Darin' Exploits iv a Brave Man be an Actual Eye-Witness, th' Account iv th' Destruction iv Spanish Power in th' Ant Hills, as it fell fr'm th' lips iv Teddy Rosenfelt an' was took down be his own hands."—*Sullivan, Our Times* (1926), I: 206.

In this year, the corruption in New York City became almost as bad as in 1894 (q. v., Ja 31), when the Lexow investigation was held, and the legislature again determined to investigate, and for this purpose sent to the city a committee, which was generally known as the "Mazet Committee." Gustavus Myers thus describes its work and the results: "This body's prestige suffered from the charge that its investigation was unduly partisan. Moreover, it was generally felt by the public that its work was inefficiently carried on. Nevertheless, it produced a considerable array of facts showing the existence of gross maladministration.

"It was disclosed that every member of the Tammany Society or of the organization's executive committee, held office, or was a favored contractor. Over \$700,000 of city orders went to favored contractors without bidding. Various city departments were 'characterized by unparalleled ignorance and unfairness.' The payrolls in some of the most important departments had increased \$1,500,000 between July 1, 1898, and September 1, 1899, and the employees had increased over 1,000, excluding policemen, firemen and teachers. The testimony proved the increasing inefficiency and demoralization of the Police and Fire Departments. It further proved the existence of a ramified system of corruption similar to that revealed by the Lexow Committee.

"The disclosures attracting the greatest public attention were those relating to the Ice Trust, the Ramapo project, and Mr. Croker's relations to the city government. On April 14 the Committee exposed a conspiracy between the Ice Trust and the Dock and other departments of the city government, to create and maintain a monopoly of New York's ice supply. Six days after the exposure, Mayor Van Wyck, as he subsequently admitted in his testimony before Judge Gaynor, acquired 5,000 shares, worth \$500,000, of the Ice Truck stock, alleging that he paid \$57,000 in cash for them; but although urged to substantiate his statement, did not produce proof that he actually paid anything. It was shown conclusively before the committee that the arrangement between the Ice Trust and the city officials was such as to compel the people to pay 60 cents a hundred pounds, and that the trust had stopped the sale of five-cent pieces of ice, practically cutting off the supply of the poor. Many other Tammany officials were equally involved. Proceedings were begun some time after, looking to an official investigation of the Ice Trust's affairs, and charges against Mayor Van Wyck were filed with Gov. Roosevelt. The latter were finally dismissed by the Governor in November, 1900.

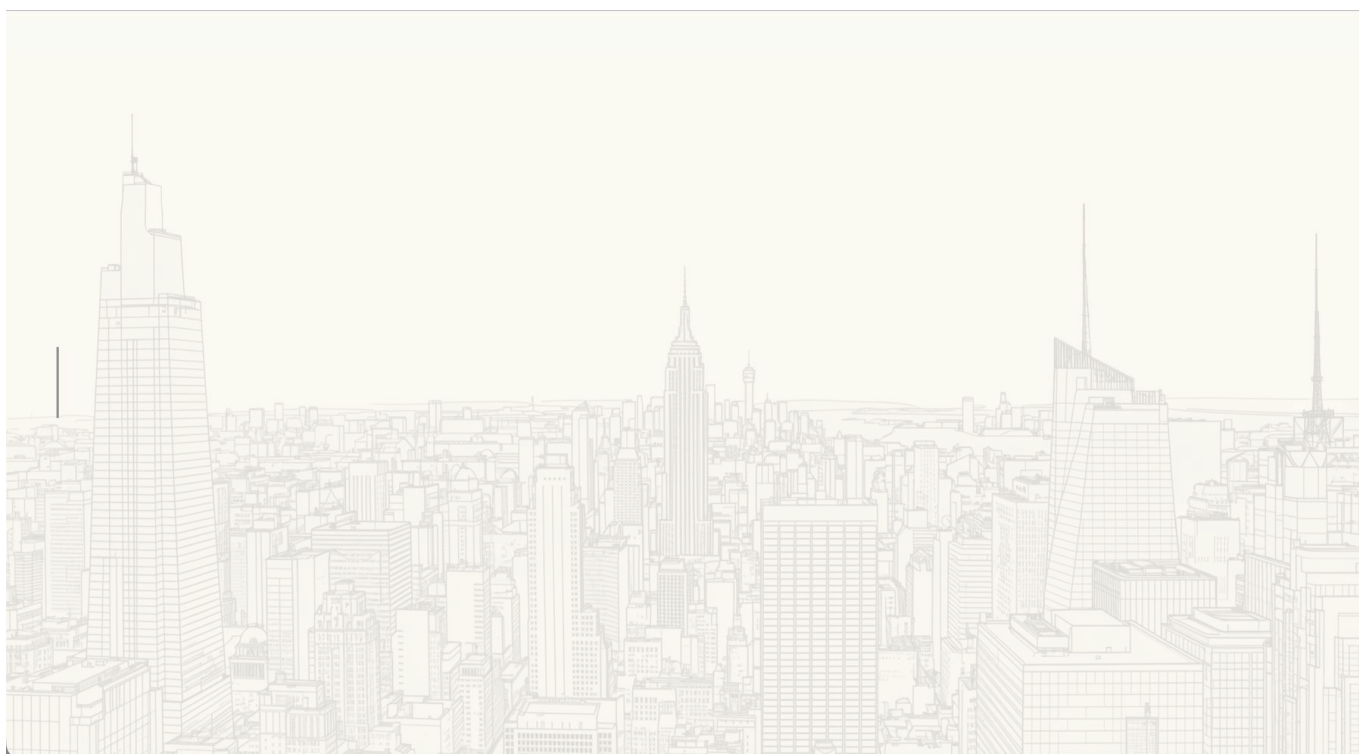
"In August, the committee uncovered the Ramapo scheme. The Ramapo Water Company, with assets 'of at least the value of \$5,000,' sought to foist upon the city a contract calling for payment from the city treasury of an enormous amount in annual installments of about \$5,110,000, in return for at least 200,000,000 gallons of water a day, at \$70 per million gallons. This was proved to be an attempt toward a most gigantic swindle. Had not Controller Coler exposed and frustrated the scheme, the Tammany members of the Board of Public Improvement would have rushed the contract to passage.

"Mr. Croker's testimony threw a flood of light upon his political views and standards as well as his powers and emoluments as 'boss.' He acknowledged that he had a powerful influence over the Tammany legislators at Albany, whose actions he advised, and that he exercised the same influence upon local officials. He readily conceded that he was the most powerful man he knew of. . . .

"Mr. Croker also admitted that judicial candidates were assessed in their districts. In fact, some of the Judges themselves named the respective sums to the committee. Judge Pryor testified that he had been asked for \$10,000 for his nomination for a vacant half-term in the Supreme Court. Other judicial candidates, it was understood, paid from \$10,000 to \$25,000 for nominations. Mr. Croker maintained that the organization was entitled to all the judicial, executive, administrative—in brief, all offices—because 'that is what the people voted our ticket for.' Mr. Croker refused to answer many questions tending to show that he profited by a silent partnership in many companies which benefited directly or indirectly by his power. . . . He declined to answer the

Ferrara, *A Guide to Gangsters*, 2009, p. 182

Quotes drawn from this page: 8



A GUIDE TO GANGSTERS, MURDERERS AND WEIRDOS OF NEW YORK CITY'S LOWER EAST SIDE

147 East Fourteenth Street

The parking lot just east of the Con Edison building is the site of what was the second location of the great political machine Tammany Hall.

Tammany Hall's first headquarters were located downtown near city hall; they moved into a building on this site in 1867. Tammany remained here until 1928, when it sold the building to Consolidated Gas and moved to its third and final location, at 100-102 East Seventeenth Street (the present-day New York Film Academy building), where it only lasted a couple of years before finally going out of business. Tammany Hall was a notoriously corrupt political organization with very close ties to the criminal underworld of the Lower East Side.

220 East Fourteenth Street

As early as 1921, "enthusiastic" supporters of Italian dictator Benito Mussolini were organizing in America. Many of the fascist sympathizers were made up of Italian veterans of World War I who had immigrated to the United States after the war. One of the largest of these groups, the eight-hundred-member Fascio Centrale, was headquartered at this address. It had over thirty branches in Italian communities throughout the United States, including Chicago and Detroit.

Fascio Centrale was founded by Gelasio Caetani, with the blessing of Mussolini. In fact, Caetani was



Mussolini's first ambassador to the United States. His mission was to harvest a good relationship with the United States, secure loans and work out trade agreements. He found that existing Mussolini supporters in the



Benito Mussolini.

Dolkart, *Gramercy*, 1996, p. 78

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NOS. 100-102 EAST 17TH STREET
Former Tammany Hall

On the southeast corner of East 17th Street and Union Square East, at 100-102 East 17th Street, stands the second of the district's institutional buildings, **Tammany Hall**, once the headquarters of New York City's Democratic Party political machine. Late in 1927, the Society of Tammany sold its headquarters on East 14th Street and announced the construction of a new Tammany Hall. Plans for the new building were made public in January 1928.⁵⁰ The building, designed by Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, was to be a Colonial Revival structure built of red Harvard brick with granite trim (limestone was later substituted). The *Real Estate Record* described the design as "a dignified architectural treatment, one of the chief motifs of which are the severe Colonial columns in the centers of the Union Square and the Seventeenth-street facades which recall the days of early American architecture."⁵¹

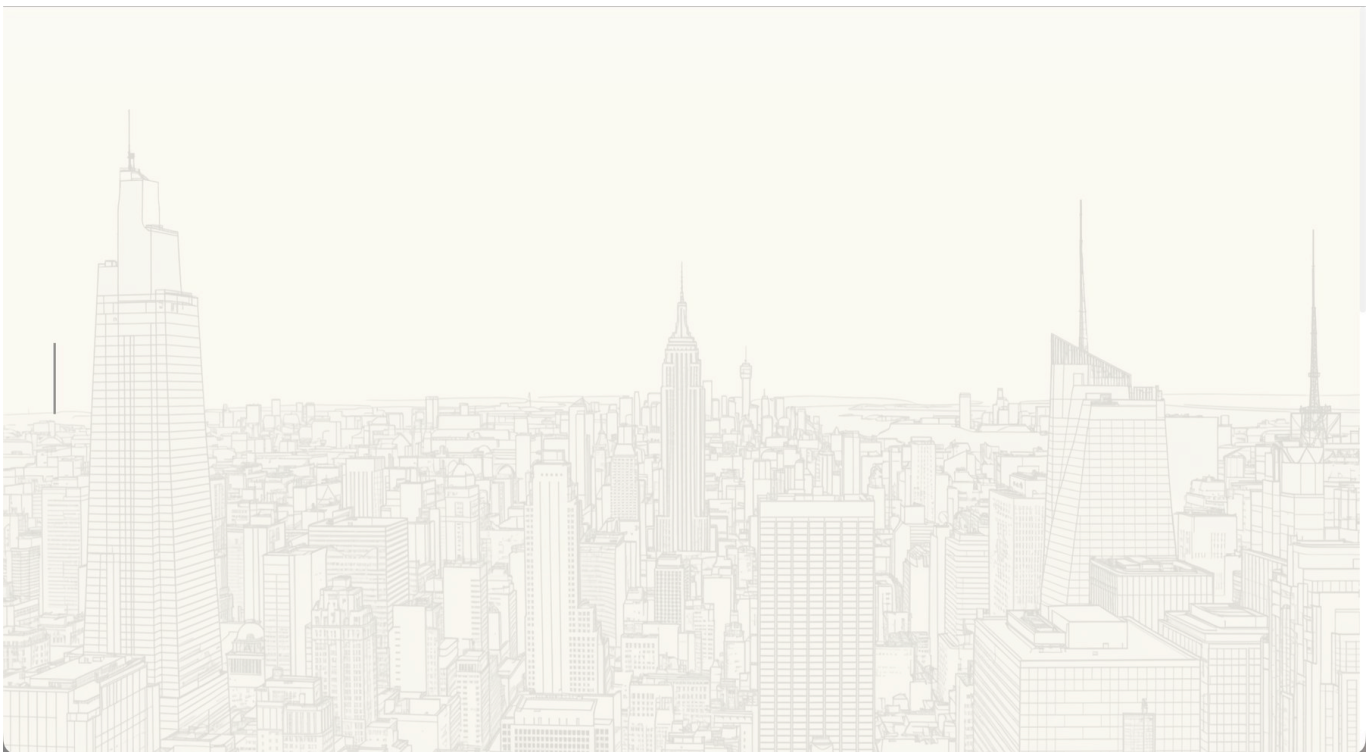
The Colonial Revival was undoubtedly chosen not only because it was reminiscent of the architecture of the early republic, but also because it symbolized the government established during that period. The Society of Tammany was attempting to associate itself with the ideals of early American democracy; in fact, the Union Square facade bears a striking resemblance to the original Federal Hall, where George Washington took the oath of office as the first President of the United States. By choosing the Colonial Revival style, with all that it symbolized, Tammany may have been attempting to create the image of a truly democratic force to counter the accusations that it was a corrupt political machine.

50. "Architects Picked for Tammany Hall," *New York Times*, January 18, 1928, p. 52; "New Tammany Hall Will Be Colonial in Design," *Real Estate Record and Builders Guide* 121 (January 28, 1928), p. 7. The *Real Estate Record* article includes an elevation drawing. A slightly different elevation drawing, closer to the building as actually constructed, was illustrated in the Architectural League's *Yearbook* (1929), n.p.

51. "New Tammany Hall..."

Trager, *Park Avenue*, 1990, p. 185

Quotes drawn from this page: 10 41



Henry Mandel took over the site and engaged the architect John Sloan; in 1922 it opened the Pershing Square Building, 100 East 42nd Street. This was the same syndicate that paid \$1.6 billion for the block bounded by Park and Lexington avenues between 32nd and 33rd streets—with assurances from the Board of Aldermen and mayor that its new building could be called 1 Park Avenue. York & Sawyer were the architects for 1 Park, which was finished in 1925. Recent tenants have included Loews Corp., a conglomerate put together by Laurence and Preston Robert Tisch, and the publisher Ziff-Davis (each has five floors; together they occupy nearly half the space). Lorillard Inc., the name on the building, is an old tobacco company owned by Loews Corp.

To the south, 386 and 419 Park Avenue South date to 1927. The latter, designed by Walter Haefeli, is at the southeast corner of 29th Street. Tammany Hall, whose "Wigwam" had stood for decades in 14th Street and whose Democratic leaders still ruled New York, moved in 1928 into a new marble building at 100 East 17th Street, corner of Fourth Avenue. (In recent years it has housed the International Ladies Garment Workers Union Local 99-105, and its 499-seat auditorium has been used by the Roundabout Theater Company, a group with 20,000 subscribers).

Between 26th and 27th streets, New York Life Insurance Company had moved in 1928 into a pyramid-topped tower designed by Cass Gilbert with an imposing three-story lobby on a site formerly occupied by Madison Square Garden (and, before that, by the old New York & Harlem Railroad terminal). Work began in 1929 on a new north building for Metropolitan Life, with great vaulted entrances at each of its four corners on 24th and 25th streets. The creation of Harvey Wiley Corbett and D. Everett Waid, it would not be finished until 1932.

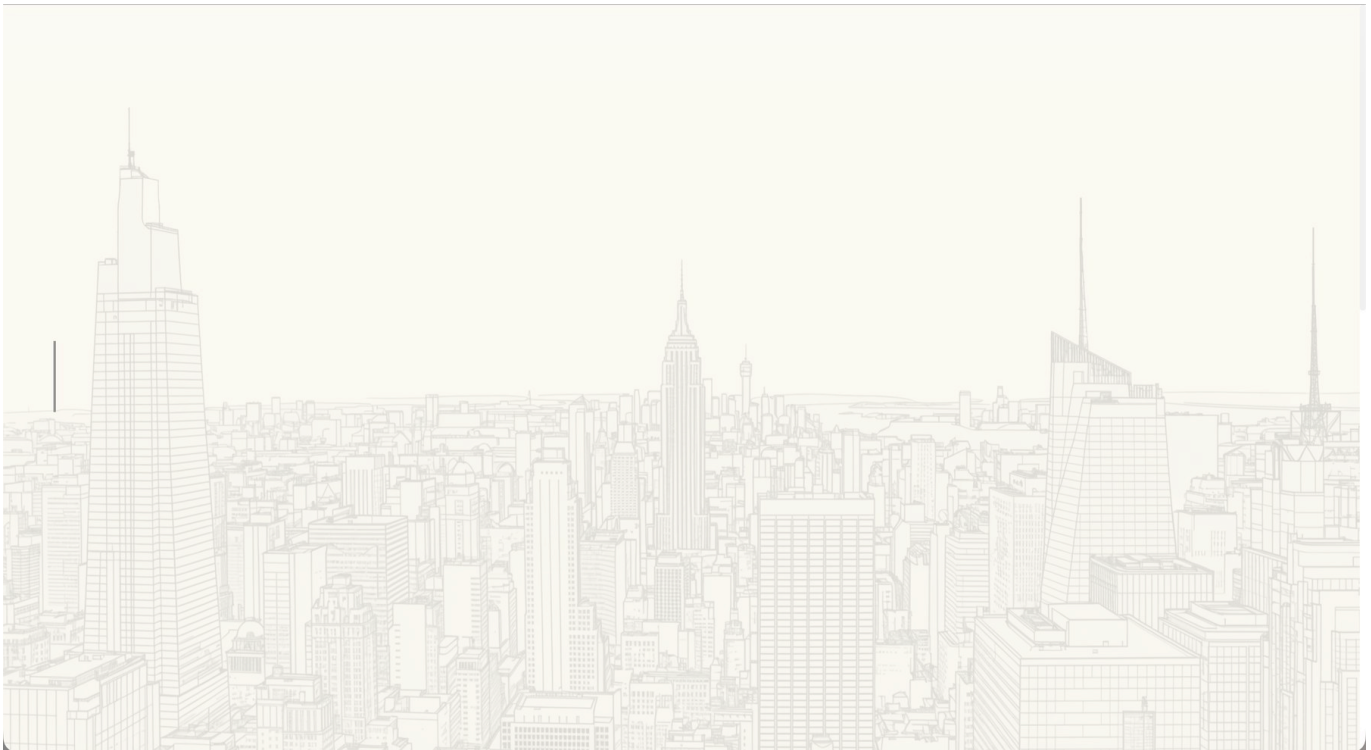
Far surpassing most of these in the opinion of Lewis Mumford was 2 Park Avenue, northwest corner 32nd Street. In this skyscraper, completed in 1927 and originally called the Park Avenue Building, the architect Ely Jacques Kahn achieved, said Mumford, "almost complete success . . . With a warm buff brick as a foundation, [it] works up into bands of sunny terra-cotta broken and accentuated with red, green, bright sky-blue. The pattern is abstract; and every part, down to the lighting fixtures, has the same finish, rigor, swiftness, perfection. In this building, structure and feeling are at last one: the directness and simplicity of the first have not been forfeited to the decoration; the warmth and human satisfaction of the decorative forms have not been overpowered in the structure itself, for they are expressed there, too. . . . One building like this, which faces the entire problem of design, and has a clean, unflinching answer for each question, might well serve to crystallize all the fumbling and uncertain elements in present-day architecture. The success of the Park Avenue Building is not due to the fact that it is a tall tower or that it is a set-back building. It is not a tower and the set-back is trifling. Its success is due to its unique synthesis of the constructive and the feeling elements . . . The Park Avenue Building

... THE PARK AVENUE BUILDING
shows the limit of the architect's skill, to date, under urban conditions, where

COMMERCIAL INCURSIONS | 185

Jackson, *The Encyclopedia of New York*, 2010, p. 1278

Quotes drawn from this page: 11 30 31 33



leader—an unsalaried, extralegal commander of operations. They also appointed precinct captains whose job it was to help families in their neighborhoods during times of emergency, to find them work, to ease any problems they had with the law, and to make sure that they voted. Although ballot boxes were often stolen on election day, most victories by candidates allied with Tammany Hall were achieved through year-round attention to voters' needs and interests. Because the boss controlled nominations to elective offices, he had the last word in the discretionary appointments made by successful candidates for municipal office and used this power to reward loyal district leaders and supporters and to punish dissenters. Political integration of different ethnic groups varied widely. From mid-century Irish men dominated Tammany Hall and virtually monopolized district leaderships, remaining in power despite the changing population of their neighborhoods. Many Jews and Germans were admitted to the Tammany Society and were chosen to be state legislators, congressional representatives, and judges. The growing Italian population was largely ignored, and when the number of black voters in Harlem became significant, the neighborhood was subdivided and reallocated to adjacent districts with white majorities. Richard Croker, the boss from 1886 to 1902, retained Kelly's system but delegated decisions about patronage to local leaders more than Kelly had done.

After consolidation in 1898 the primacy of Tammany Hall depended on gaining the cooperation of Democrats in the outer boroughs. Those in Brooklyn opposed the organization until John McCooney became the leader of Kings County in 1909. He was a longtime friend of Croker's successor, Charles F. Murphy. One result of their collaboration was the nomination of two mayoral candidates from Brooklyn, William J. Gaynor in 1909 and John F. Hylan in 1921. In state government during these years politicians allied with Tammany Hall sponsored progressive labor laws and opposed Prohibition and censorship. Murphy promised the suffrage leader Carrie Chapman Catt that his organization would do nothing to prevent women from gaining the right to vote; women were later allowed to be district co-leaders but rarely had a voice in decisions. After Murphy's death the leaders decided to replace Mayor Hylan with James J. Walker, a member of Tammany Hall and a state senator. Their efforts were successful owing largely to the support of Edward J. Flynn, the leader in the Bronx, and to an effective campaign against Hylan by Governor Alfred E. Smith; after winning the Democratic primary they swept the November elections.

The machine received money and "kickbacks" from many sources: municipal suppliers, real estate interests, aspirants for judge-ships, and businessmen bidding for transit

franchises and pier leases. Legal fees and brokerage commissions were funneled to politically active lawyers and insurance agents, and generous campaign contributions were often made by such wealthy families as the Lehmans and the Strauses. Members of the inner circle profited from "honest graft," successful speculations based on confidential information about plans for schools and public works. As George Washington Plunkitt, a sachem who died a millionaire, declared, "I seen my opportunities and I took 'em."

Tammany Hall reached its zenith in 1928. Smith was a powerful and widely respected governor; Walker was an extraordinarily popular mayor; and George W. Olvany, a college graduate, was the boss. A new building was completed in 1929 on Union Square at 17th Street, and during this period even reformers had few criticisms of Tammany Hall. But the organization's fortunes soon changed. Investigations of civic corruption by Samuel Seabury led to Walker's resignation in 1932. John F. Curry, Olvany's successor, sought to block Franklin D. Roosevelt's presidential nomination, allowing Flynn, no longer an ally of Tammany Hall, to become the strongest link between the Democratic White House and the city. In 1933 Mayor John P. O'Brien, the incumbent and a loyalist chosen by Curry, finished last in a three-way mayoral election won by Fiorello H. La Guardia, who led a coalition opposed to Tammany Hall that remained in place for 12 years. Unable to meet mortgage payments, the sachems sold their building to Local 91 of the International Ladies' Garment Workers' Union in 1943. By the time the Democrats recaptured the mayoralty in 1945, Tammany Hall had virtually ceased to exist, although politicians bred in the organization continued to flourish into the 1950s and beyond.

Louis Eisenstein and Elliot Rosenberg, *A Stripe of Tammany's Tiger* (New York: R. Speller, 1966); Alfred Connable and Edward Silberfarb, *Tigers of Tammany: Nine Men Who Ran New York* (New York: Holt, Rinehart and Winston, 1967)

See also DEMOCRATIC PARTY.

Frank Vos

Tannenbaum, Frank (b. Brod, Galicia, 4 March 1893; d. New York City, 1 June 1969). Historian. After moving from a farm near Great Barrington, Massachusetts, to New York City in 1906 he joined the Industrial Workers of the World. In 1914 he was imprisoned for almost a year on Blackwell's Island for disturbing the peace by leading homeless men into churches to demand financial assistance and work. He received a PhD in economics in 1927 from the Brookings Institution and began teaching at Columbia in 1935, becoming a full professor of Latin American history in 1945. He founded and directed the interdisciplinary University Seminars at Columbia, which grew from five seminars in 1945

to more than 90 by 2008. Tannenbaum's published writings on Latin America were numerous. He also wrote on crime and prison reform, the labor movement, and race relations and edited the book *A Community of Scholars: The University Seminars at Columbia* (1965).

Joseph Maier and Richard W. Weatherhead, *Frank Tannenbaum: A Biographical Essay* (New York: Columbia University, 1974)

See also UNEMPLOYMENT MOVEMENTS.

Bernard Hirschhorn

tap dancing. The origins of tap dancing in New York City may be traced to the Five Points of the 1840s, where the African dances of blacks and the jigs and clog dances of the Irish exerted a reciprocal influence. Early tap dancers included the black minstrel Master Juba (William Henry Lane) and his white rival, Master John Diamond, who in 1844 faced each other in a competition at John Tryon's Amphitheater that Master Juba won. During the last third of the nineteenth century, black vaudevillians further refined the tap style, which was more rhythmic and looser than most other dances in vogue at the time.

The successful musical *Shuffle Along* (1921) by Flourney Miller, Aubrey Lyles, Noble Sissle, and Eubie Blake, which opened at Daly's Music Hall on 63rd Street, helped to establish tap dancing on the Broadway stage. In 1923 *Runnin' Wild* (also by Miller and Lyles) opened at the Colonial Theater and featured the Charleston, a fusion of tap and ballroom dancing that became immensely popular. Tap dancing was now important to the success of Broadway revues. The first great proponent of tap dancing was BILL "BOJANGLES" ROBINSON. After several years on the vaudeville circuit, he performed at clubs in Harlem and then appeared in *Blackbirds of 1928* by Lew Leslie and Will Vodery. He later danced in other Broadway shows and revues and eventually moved to Hollywood. Robinson's success inspired many tap dancers during the 1930s, among them Honi Coles, King Rastus Brown, Peg Leg Bates (who tapped on one leg), and such duos as Buck and Bubbles (Ford Lee Washington and John Washington Bubbles), Chuck and Chuckles (Charles Green and James Walker), and Stump and Stumpy (James Cross and Harold Cromer). The brothers Fayard and Harold Nicholas, who regularly performed their acrobatic tap dances at the Cotton Club and the Apollo Theater during the early 1930s, appeared on Broadway in Florenz Ziegfeld's *Follies* (1936) and in *Babes in Arms* (1937), by Richard Rodgers and Lorenz Hart.

Although tap remained essentially a black art form during the 1930s and 1940s, there were many important white tap dancers as well, including Fred Astaire, Ruby Keeler, and Gene Kelly. Clarence "Buddy" Bradley taught tap to white students and introduced creative

Unknown Author, *Landmarks Preservation Commission*, n.d., p. 1

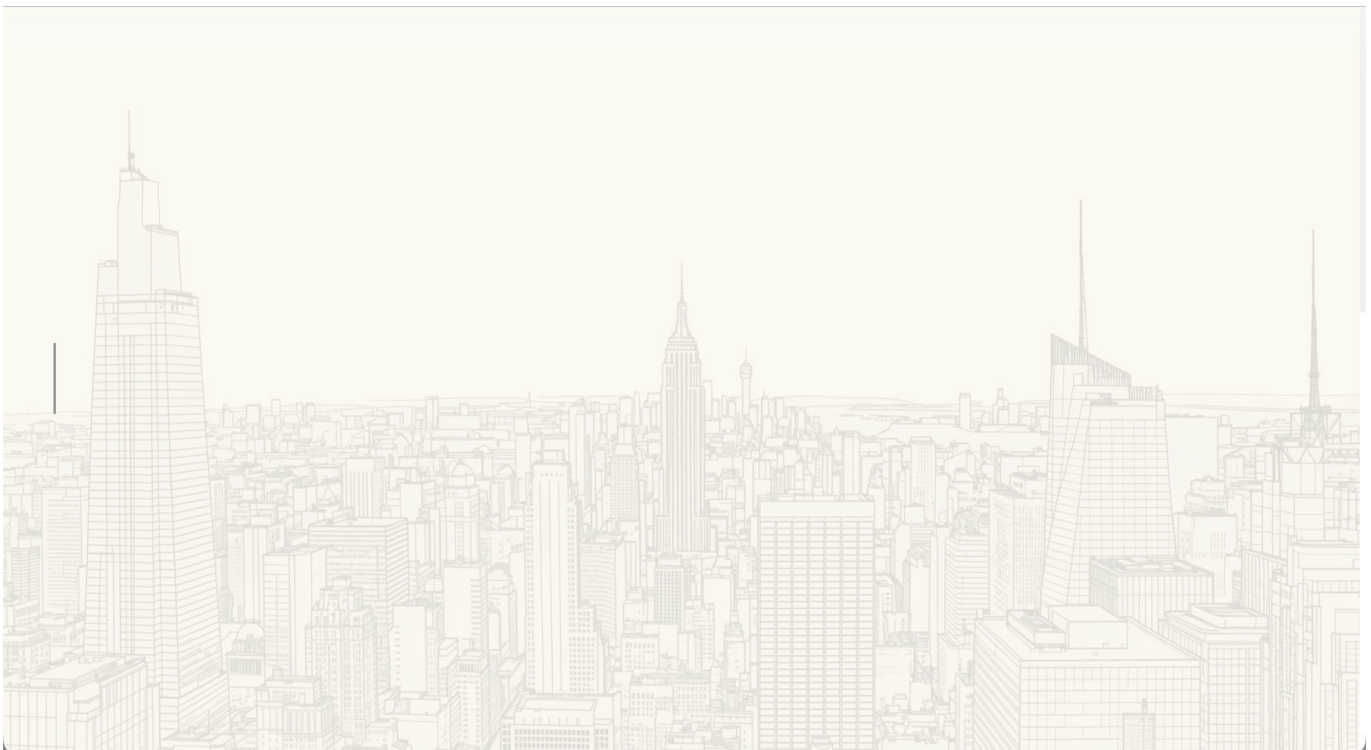
Quotes drawn from this page: 12

“Was built in 1929.”

- LANDMARKS PRESERVATION COMMISSION • 1929
- P. 1

Mentioned as: “44 Union Square East”

[View Document Image](#)



LPC, *Union Square*, 1929, p. 1

Quotes drawn from this page: 16

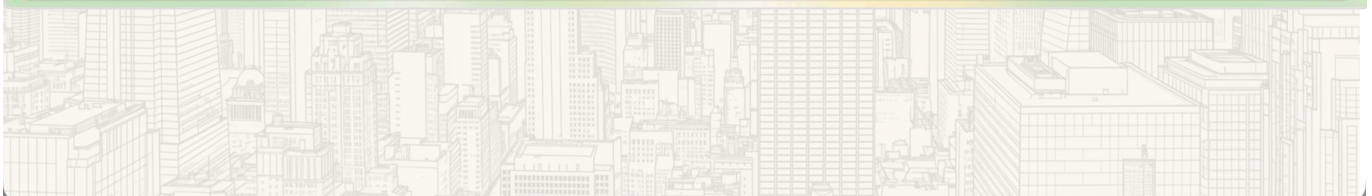


"<Architecture Style>_neo-Georgian, Contemporary,
<Base Material>_Rusticated Limestone, <Façade
Material>_Clinker Brick, Limestone, Terra Cotta,
<Entrance Description>_Molded Arched Surround,
Gothic Arched Transom, <Window Detail>_2nd fl.
Balcony, Flat Arch Brick Lintels, Stone Keystones,
Projecting Sills, Window Panes: [8/8], Window Panes:
[12/12], <Brickwork Style>_Doric Pilasters, Doric
Columns, Pedimented Portico, Double Height Pilasters,
Stone Console Brackets, Quoins, Sculptural Relief Tablet,
Rondels, <Roofline Description>_Doric Entablature,
Garlands, Roundel, Balustrade, Hipped Roof, Brick/
Stone Parapet, Construction: Hipped Roof Changing to
Shell Dome."

LPC · (1929) UNION SQUARE · 1929 · P. 1

Mentioned as: "44-48 Union Square East"

[View Document Image](#)



Spielvogel, *The Landmarks of New York*, 2016, p. 679

Quotes drawn from this page: 17 27 28 38 55





NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY

NEW YORK FILM ACADEMY, FORMERLY
ROUNDAABOUT THEATRE; LOCAL 91 OF
ILGWU; TAMMANY HALL

1928–29; 1943; 1984; 1991; 1994;
2001; 2005

100 EAST 17TH STREET, (AKA 100–102
EAST 17TH STREET, 44–48 UNION
SQUARE, 44–48 UNION SQUARE EAST),
MANHATTAN.

ARCHITECTS: THOMPSON, HOLMES &
CONVERSE AND CHARLES B. MEYERS

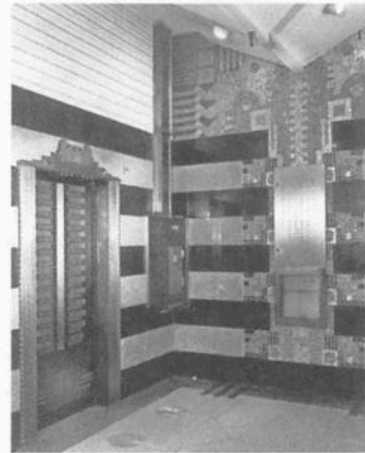
DESIGNATED: OCTOBER 29, 2013

Tammany Hall, now a byword for municipal corruption, once dominated the City's political arena. An outgrowth of the eighteenth-century Tammany Society, Tammany Hall quickly became affiliated with the newly formed Democratic Party, promoting public education, universal suffrage for white males, and helping to abolish debtors' prisons; as well as providing support for newly arrived Irish, French, and German immigrants. By the mid-nineteenth century, Tammany was firmly in charge of the municipal government, and under the leadership of the now infamous "Boss" William Tweed. His fall, and the emergence of a "New Tammany" in the

1920s, refashioned as a "good government" organization, has been identified by some as the impetus for the construction of this New Tammany Hall, the only surviving headquarters building of Tammany.

This distinguished neo-Georgian façade, with its rusticated stone base, double-height pilasters, and sculptural reliefs in terra cotta and limestone, was inspired by the original Federal Hall (demolished 1812) on Wall Street, where the first President of the United States, George Washington, took his oath of office. Clad with specially molded and oversized brick laid in Flemish bond, other neo-Georgian elements of the façade, such as the blind arches that frame the multilight sash windows, the fanlight transoms, wrought iron balconies, and semicircular attic window, deliberately evoke the dignity of early American architecture.

In 1929, when the building was completed, Tammany had again fallen out of favor, and by 1943, the Society sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies Garment Workers Union, which occupied it until 1984. That year, the Local entered into a lease agreement with the Roundabout Theatre, which renovated and occupied the building's auditorium until 1991, when it moved to 45th Street. Local 91 subsequently leased the auditorium to producer Raymond L. Gaspard, and then to the owners of Minetta Lane Theatre. In 1994, the Local began leasing portions of the building not occupied by the theater to the New York Film Academy; in 2001, the entire building was sold to Liberty Theatres



FILM CENTER BUILDING INTERIOR

and four years later the air rights were conveyed to US Development LLC.

FILM CENTER BUILDING INTERIOR

1928–29

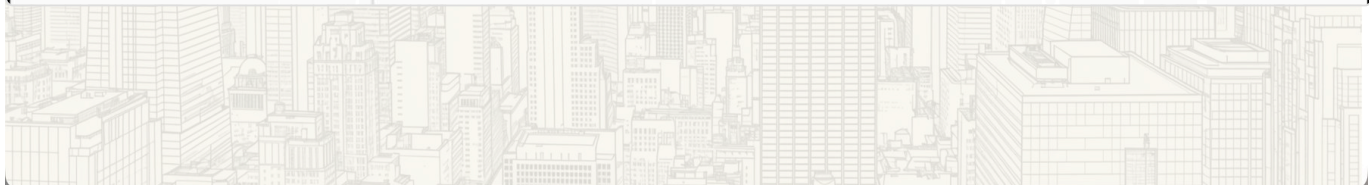
630 NINTH AVENUE, MANHATTAN

ARCHITECT: ELY JACQUES KAHN

DESIGNATED: NOVEMBER 9, 1982

The Film Center Building's interiors are among the most colorful and inventive surviving Art Deco ensembles in New York City. Walls and ceilings are treated as woven plaster tapestries, a motif frequently employed by architect Ely Jacques Kahn. He may have been influenced by Frank Lloyd Wright's California textile block houses, which were built in the mid-1920s; both architects shared an interest in Mayan architecture, which seems evident in their work.

In the outer vestibule, an ornamental plaster band runs across the ceiling and



Hennessy, *Walking Broadway*, 2020, p. 95

Quotes drawn from this page: 18 22 32 40



➡ Notable Buildings Around Union Square

A Union Square Savings Bank

20 Union Square East

1905-7 · HENRY BACON

This serious, well-proportioned, and understated treasure box was designed by the architect of the Lincoln Memorial in

Washington, D.C. A handsome Corinthian portico faces Union Square, taking full advantage of the prominent site. The bank is now a theater.



871.1

B Tammany Hall

872.1 44 Union Square East

1928 · THOMPSON, HOLMES
& CONVERSE WITH CHARLES
BRADFORD MEYERS

The Tammany Society, New York's Democratic political

machine, virtually controlled the city during the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. At the peak of its power in the 1920s the society erected this clubhouse as its headquarters. The Union Square facade of the building including the first-floor balcony under the portico was deliberately modelled on that of New York's original Federal Hall on Wall Street (demolished 1812) where Washington was inaugurated as our nation's first President.

By the early 1930s the extent of the society's graft and corruption was widely recognized, and Tammany Mayor James J. Walker was forced to resign in 1932. A decade later the society sold its meeting



0

Chase, *New York The Wonder City*, 1932, p. 23

Quotes drawn from this page: 19 23 24 25 26



TAMMANY HALL

AND

POLITICS IN NEW YORK

TAMMANY HALL!!—revered by its constituents; feared by neutrals; hated by its opponents!

The New York Tammany Society was founded about 1786, and organized under a constitution in 1789 as a charitable and patriotic order. It has gradually developed into one of the most powerful political influences in the history of our nation.

Deriving its name from a sachem of the Delaware Indians (Tammany—one of the chiefs of the Algonquins, living on the banks of the Delaware River, who for years held undisputed sway over Eastern America) this great society, from its very organization became a dominating factor in the councils of the Democratic Party and has commanded such a power in local, state, and even national politics, that the name "Tammany" has become known world over.



JOHN R. VOORHIS
102 Years of Age.
Born in July, 1829.
Elected Grand Sachem
of Tammany for 20th
term on May, 1931.

Tammany Hall is the shrine at which hundreds of thousands of loyal democrats worship, and point with pride to its achievements. On the other hand, its opponents damn Tammany Hall as the hellish headquarters for graft, corruption, and misused power!

Has any institution ever organized outside of fanatical religious circles, been so beloved or so hated; so lauded or so execrated; so eulogized or so condemned!

At the time this is written, a new legislative investigation of New York City's administration has Tammany under fire on charges of various misdeeds. But it would be premature to forecast the outcome. It will not be denied, however, that Tammany's history reveals the names of many of America's most prominent and respected sons, who are or have been enrolled as members.

Records also show that vast sums have been donated to charity or expended in relieving distress—not only in New York and America, but all over the world, such as generous contributions to Japan's earthquake sufferers, the Cuban Freedom Fund, the Irish Bond Issue, the Messina earthquake disaster, etc. Those who can see no good in Tammany insist that Tammany is an agency of Satan and that policy prompts these benefactions. They claim that all this is merely a part for a price paid for votes and popularity.

Therefore, any estimate of Tammany to be formed by a stranger, must be based largely on whether information or data concerning the institution is furnished by a Tammany supporter, or a Tammany opponent.

New York politics are so intimately identified with Tammany Hall it is said that the Democratic Party in New York City is so completely controlled by this powerful organization that no nominee has even a fighting chance for victory unless endorsed by Tammany.



In State politics, also, Tammany commands an influence which is widespread and generally conceded to be a power that must be thoroughly recognized.

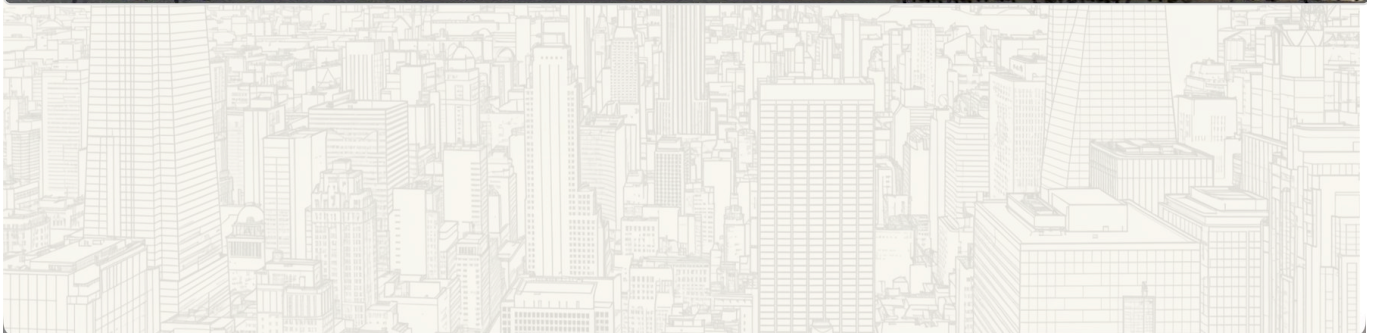
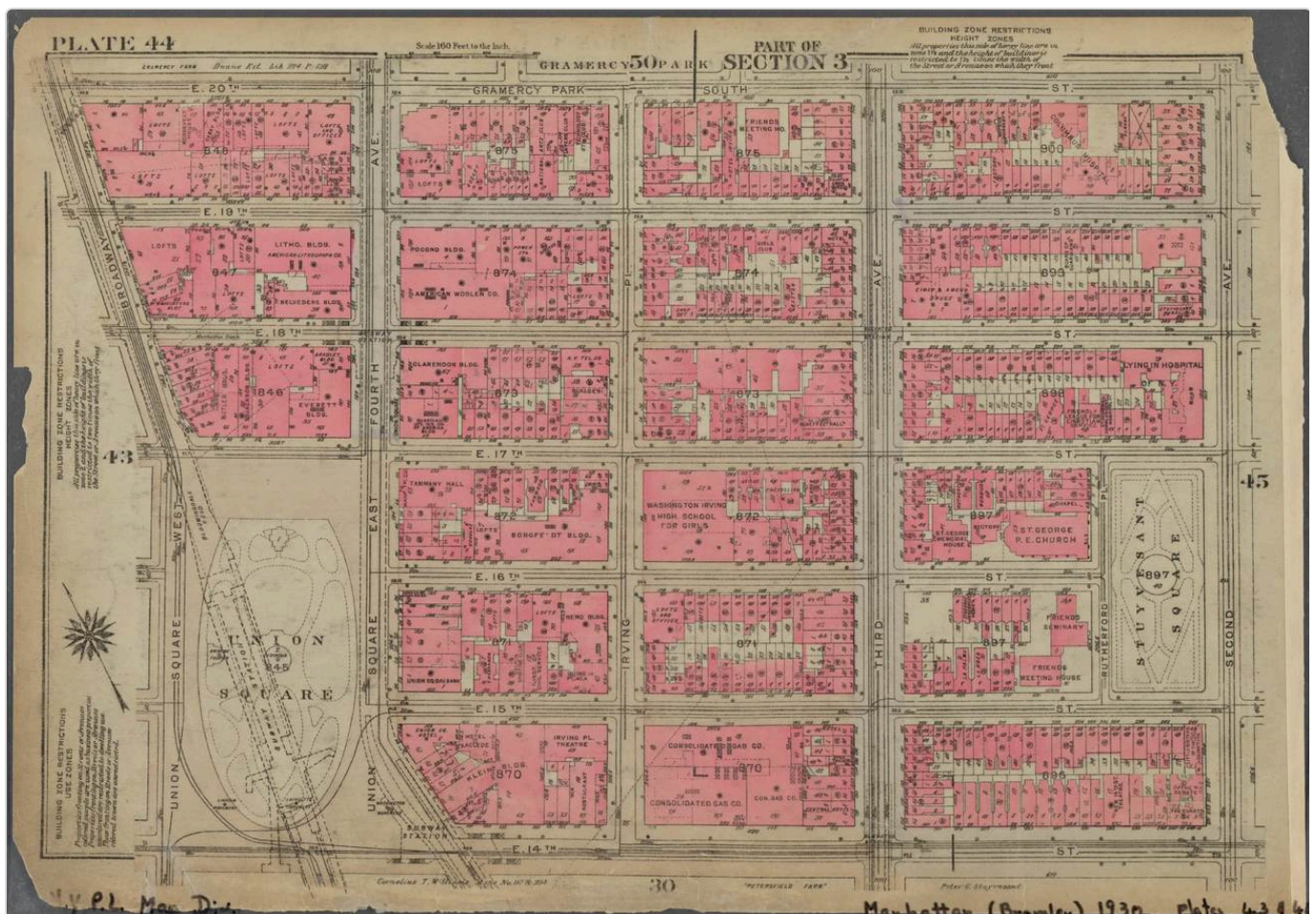
The new Tammany Hall, facing Union Square at 17th Street and 4th Avenue. Built in 1929.

23

872.1

Bromley, 1930 Land Book of the Borough of Manhattan, 1930, p. 54

Quotes drawn from this page: 20



Reynolds, *Monuments and Masterpieces*, 1988, p. 187

Quotes drawn from this page: 21 59



Union Square, a park that has meant independence and freedom of speech for generations. There, especially during the 1930s, people came to speak their minds without fear of assault or arrest. Appropriately, the statues of Washington, Lincoln, Lafayette, and most recently Gandhi, share axes with the Independence Flagstaff. And it is fitting, as one stands to read the flagstaff's historic friezes with their idealized, almost life-size figures of Indians, pioneer families, horses, and buffaloes, portraying the American struggle for independence, that another liberty cap—across the street in the pediment of the old Tammany meeting place at 100 East Seventeenth Street—is eminently visible as it oversees the park and the Charles F. Murphy Monument.

Stone as Symbol

Plaques set into great boulders and outcroppings of Manhattan schist, the stone that is millions of years old upon which Manhattan is built, have a special character because of the meaning of stone. The solidity, integrity, and permanence of stone have been recognized from early times as the antithesis of biological things, which are subject to laws of change, decay, and death. Ancient cultures worshiped stones as possessing magic powers and as dwelling places of the gods. They treated certain stones with special respect. In the book of Genesis, the stone Jacob took from a sacred shrine and used as a pillow when he dreamed of the prophetic stairway between God and man, he interpreted as the abode of God and set up as a memorial stone. Alchemists thought the philosopher's stone contained the power to transform baser metals into gold.

Megaliths

Monumental stones were used by ancient cultures to mark sacred places and burial sites. Historians call these massive markers megaliths, which means "great stones," and they date from as early as 3000 B.C. If they are dressed—that is, cut and prepared—they are called monoliths. Great boulders in their primitive and natural state, then, are associated with people's earliest attempts to deal with notions of death. These associations continue even into modern times. Following World War II, for example, rough-hewn natural boulders had widespread appeal as commemorative markers, and they are found throughout the city in all boroughs bearing



Wolfe, *New York 15 Walking Tours*, 2003, p. 250

Quotes drawn from this page: 29 35 36 37 39



familiar sight in the city. With the departure of the insurance company, the building was converted into a hotel (Rockwell Group, 2001). Alas, the old sign is gone (despite a public outcry), replaced by the hotel's own. Interestingly, the former name of Guardian was the Germania Life Insurance Company, but anti-German sentiment during World War I resulted in a reshuffling of the letters of Germania to Guardian. The aluminum and glass annex to the east was designed in 1961 by Skidmore, Owings & Merrill.

Around the corner, the trim neo-Federal-style brick-and-limestone building, No. 100 East 17th Street (Thompson, Holmes & Converse and Charles B. Meyers, 1929), was the "final resting place" of **Tammany Hall**, the Democratic political machine that held the city in a corrupt stranglehold for almost two centuries. The club was founded in 1788 as an outgrowth of the patriotic Sons of Liberty and called The Society of St. Tammany or Columbian Order. According to local preservationist Jack Taylor, "the building is such a great example of Colonial Revival, of a time when a group tried to burnish its crooked reputation by linking itself to early American ideals," adding, "the history of Tammany Hall, shabby as it is, is also a big part of our past, and this building is the sole physical remnant of that." While awaiting the city's decision on landmark designation, it was suggested that the Tammany Hall building be converted into a "Museum of Political Corruption"; however, one wag observed that "it just wouldn't be large enough!"

By 1943, unable to meet its mortgage payments, Tammany sold the building to Local 91 of the International Ladies Garment Workers Union. In 2001, they, in turn, sold it to Liberty Theaters, who remodeled the union's former meeting hall—once called the Roosevelt Auditorium—into the present **Union Square Theater**. The building is also home to the **New York Film Academy**, a noted school for filmmakers.

At East 15th Street, look above the ground floor of No. 24–33 at the dingy cast-iron façade of the **former S. Klein-on-the-Square Department Store**. Klein's first opened on the Square in 1910, but by 1921 relocated to a rambling emporium that grew northward from 14th to 16th streets. For years, its huge distinctive neon "On the Square" sign atop the complex was a familiar city landmark. Klein's was a pioneer in discount merchandising, and its frequent sales would always attract hordes of bargain hunters. By 1975, however, competition from other discount stores and its distance from the city's new shopping centers, plus old-fashioned merchandising techniques and a rather decrepit interior, hastened its demise. The southwest corner of Klein's 15th Street building was earlier the site of the posh **Union Square Hotel**, a favorite with the Theater District celebrities of the Gilded Age.

At the northeast corner is the **former Union Square Savings Bank**, now the **Daryl Roth Theatre**, No. 20 Union Square East (Henry Bacon, 1905). Like a vestige of ancient Greece, the white granite-front structure boasts a façade of bold Corinthian columns, in a style favored by architect Bacon, whose major work is the Lincoln Memorial in Washington, D.C. The bank closed in 1992, but the van-

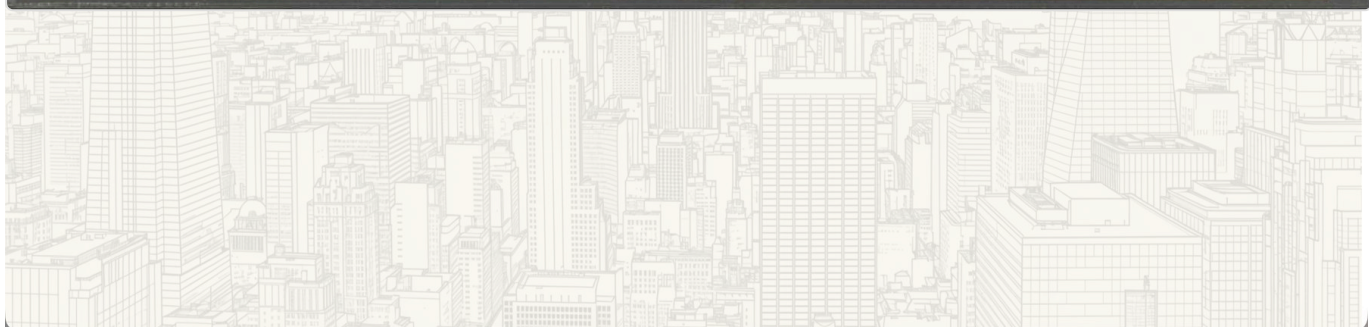
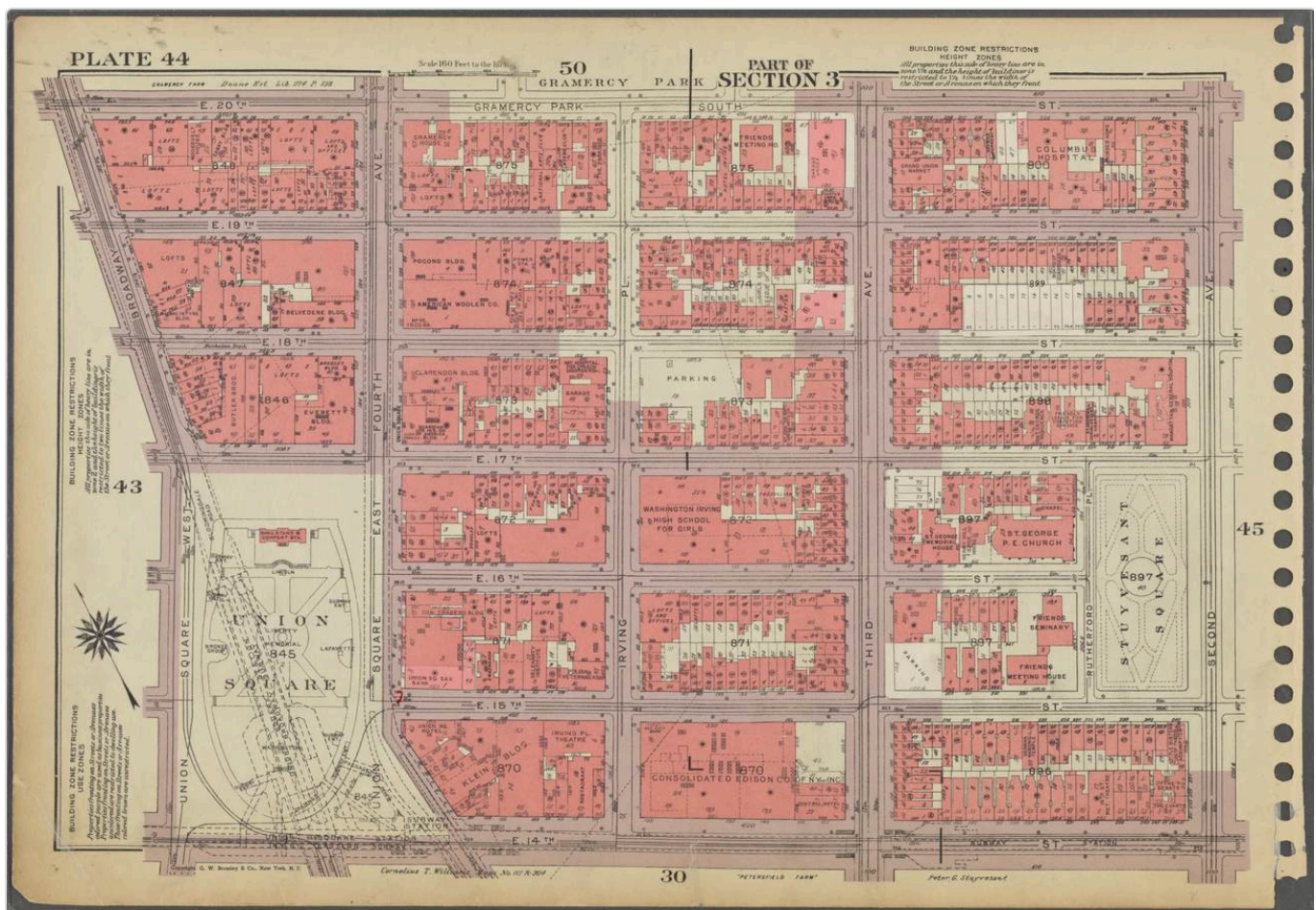
the LINCOLN MEMORIAL in Washington, D.C. THE BANK CLOSED IN 1972, but the venerable building is now enjoying a new life, with the former banking hall remodeled and converted for novel and unconventional theatrical productions.

Walk into the park to the **bronze Statue of Lafayette**, by famed French sculptor Frédéric Auguste Bartholdi (1876). While collecting funds for his later Statue

845.1

Bromley, 1955 *Manhattan Land Book*, 1955, p. 44

Quotes drawn from this page: 34



Lawliss, *The New York Theatre Sourcebook*, 1981, p. 183

Quotes drawn from this page: 42 43 44



ROUNABOUT THEATRE COMPANY

▲ **100 East 17th Street** at Park Avenue South

▲ **Box Office:** 420-1883

▲ **Seating:** 499 (Orchestra 358; Mezzanine, 141)

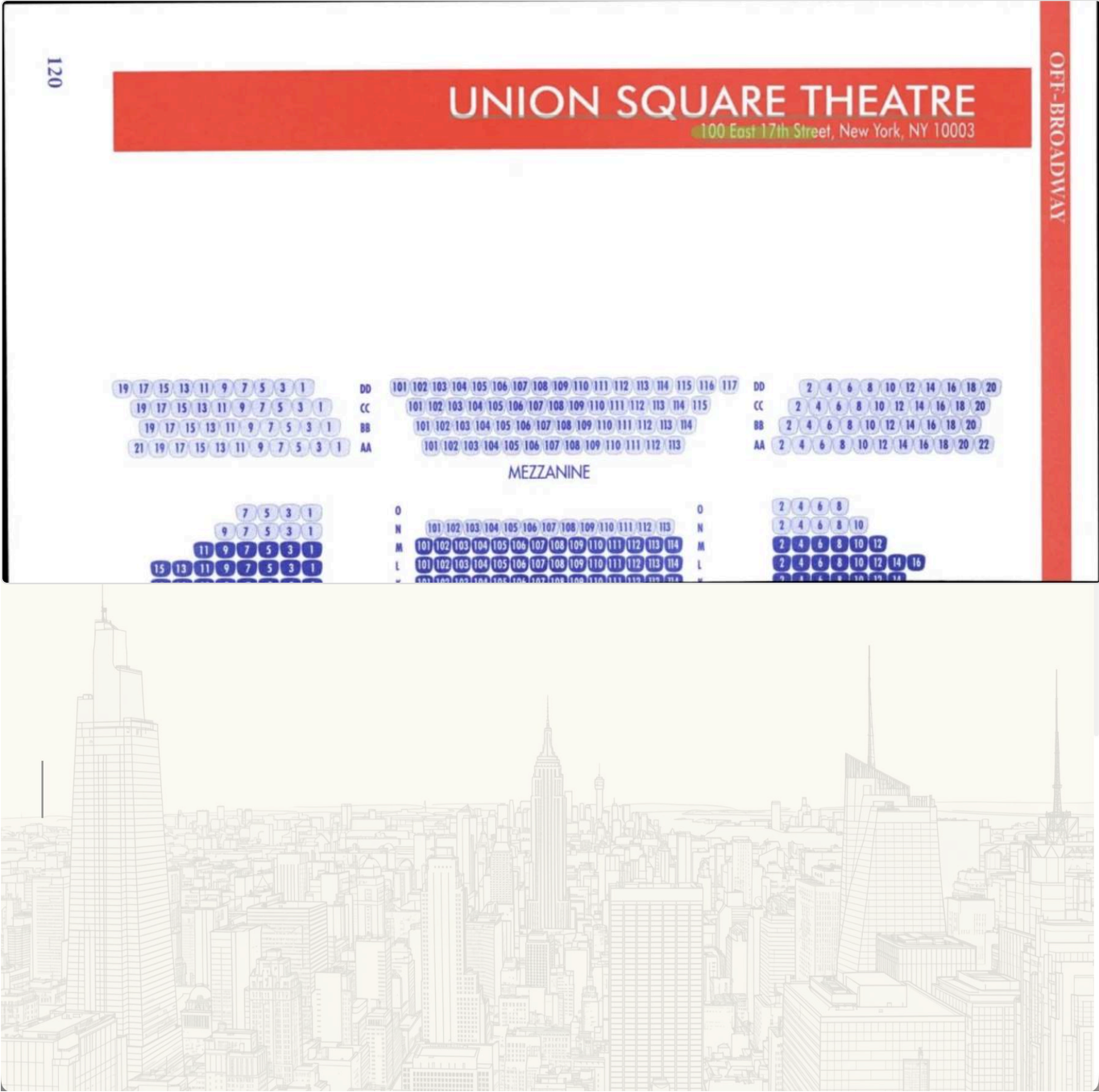
▲ **Handicapped:** Semi-accessible

Since its founding in 1965 Artistic Director Gene Feist has built the Roundabout into one of the major nonprofit theatrical institutions in the country. A number of well-known actors got their New York start here, including Amanda Plummer, David Dukes, B. D. Wong, Kate Burton, Danny Glover, and Jerry Zaks. Roundabout's outstanding productions have included *Look Back in Anger* by John Osborne, starring Malcolm McDowell, which was made into a film for PBS; *A Raisin in the Sun* by Lorraine Hansberry, starring Esther Rolle and Danny Glover, which transferred to Kennedy Center and was made into a film for PBS; *The Winslow Boy* by Terence Rattigan, which toured nationally; *A Man for All Seasons* by Robert Bolt, starring Philip Bosco and Charles Keating; *Rosencrantz and Guildenstern Are Dead*, by Tom Stoppard, starring John Wood, Stephan Lang, and John Rubenstein, production supervised by Tom Stoppard; *Mrs. Warren's Profession* by George Bernard Shaw, starring Uta Hagen and Pamela Reed; *Old Times* by Harold Pinter, starring Jane Alexander, Marsha Mason, and Anthony Hopkins; *Room Service* by John Murray and Allen Boretz, directed by Alan Arkin, starring Mark Hamill, Lonny Price, and Keith Reddin; and *The Browning Version*, by Terence Rattigan, starring Lee Richardson and Sheila Allen. Two productions that originated here went to Broadway: *Joe Egg* by Peter Nichols, starring Jim Dale and Stockard Channing, moved to the Longacre (Ms. Channing won a Tony and the production won a Tony and Drama Desk and Outer Critics Circle awards for outstanding revival; *A Taste of Honey* by Shelagh Delaney, starring Amanda Plummer and Valerie French, moved to the Century.

In 1984 the Roundabout converted a 1,000-seat auditorium in the old Tammany Hall into an intimate 500-seat theatre. Roundabout offers various theatre tours. In October Mr. Feist takes a group to London to see productions and meet London theatre professionals. Other tours visit Russia and India in the spring and Edinburgh in August (tour information: 420-1360). Roundabout offers ten-week courses in acting technique, scene study, and audition seminars. Actors' survival seminars are held several times a year. A recent season at the Roundabout included *The Tempest*, starring Frank Langella and B. D. Wong; *Privates on Parade* by Peter Nichols, starring Jim Dale, Simon Jones, and John Curry; *Member of the Wedding* by Carson McCullers, starring Esther Rolle; and *Enrico IV* by Luigi Pirandello, starring Paul Hecht in his Obie-winning role.

Millman, *Seats*, 1998, p. 120

Quotes drawn from this page: 45



Lanigan-Schmidt, *Ghosts of New York City*, 2003, p. 64

Quotes drawn from this page: 46 56 57 58



season in 1916 utilizing the parlor floor of 139 MacDougal.

In 1917, they refurbished a four-story, pre-Victorian structure that was once a storehouse, stable and bottling works at #133 into a theatre seating 182 people. Among the plays first shown there included *The Emperor Jones*, which launched Paul Robeson's career and *The Hairy Ape*, both by O'Neill. The theatre was also home to Gertrude Stein and Edna St. Vincent Millay. Bette Davis appeared there early in her career.

Still a working theatre, long-time staffers swear it is haunted. They have noted odd sounds and a cold, opaque form that passes them on the steps.

Thimble Theatre

10 Fifth Avenue basement

The Thimble Theatre was located in the basement of the 1845 brownstone that still stands at 10 Fifth Avenue. Home to the ghost of the theatre's founder, Guido Bruno, a Greenwich Village eccentric usually identified by his flashy, ill-fitting plaid suits. Bruno is recognized as the originator of performance art and his theatre presented the U.S. debut of Strindberg's *Miss Julie*.

After Bruno's death, an occupant of the former theatre (which is now a basement apartment) recounted peculiar happenings, such as music playing from no visible source and objects sailing across the room.

The Union Square Theatre

100 East 17th Street



Union Square Theatre. Courtesy of Margaret Cotter.

Grader, *The Cheap Bastards Guide to NYC*, 2002, p. 16

Quotes drawn from this page: 47



UNION SQUARE THEATRE

100 East 17th Street (between Union Square East and Irving Place)

(212) 505-0700 **872.1**

Ushers per performance: 5

A large Off Broadway house that has played host to such shows as *Wit*, *The Laramie Project*, *BatBoy*, and others. Call one to three weeks in advance.

VARIETY ARTS THEATER

110 Third Avenue (between 13th and 14th Streets) **559**

Ushers per performance: As needed

This theater has a regular ushering staff and uses volunteers only on an as-needed basis. To sign up for a date, you need to drop by the theater when the house manager is available. This means near or during a performance. The best time to stop by is about 8:30 or 9:15 Tuesday through Saturday, and 3:30 or 4:15 on Saturday and Sunday. Usually hosts high-profile Off Broadway shows such as the Pulitzer Prize-winning *Dinner with Friends*.

THE VINEYARD THEATRE

870.1

108 East 15th Street (between Union Square East and Irving Place)

(212) 353-3366, ext. 226 (usher hotline)

www.vineyardtheatre.org

Ushers per performance: 2

The Vineyard produces and develops new works by many major figures in the American theater. They have brought to life such shows as *Fully Committed*, the Pulitzer Prize-winning *How I Learned to Drive*, and *Three Tall Women*. Make reservations one to three weeks in advance.

639

WESTBETH THEATRE CENTER

151 Bank Street (Washington Street and West Side Highway)

(212) 691-2272

www.westbeththeatre.com

Ushers per performance: 3

Presents and develops theater and music performances, many of which end up transferring to larger theaters around New York, regional theaters, and around the world. Notable performances have included Eddy Izzard, Sandra Bernhard, Marc Maron, *Hedwig and the Angry Inch*, Billy Connelly, Ray Davies, the Losers Lounge, Lypsinka, and Margaret Cho. They don't use volunteer ushers for every show; call for details.



Village Voice, *Village Voice January 31st 1995, 1995*, p. 1

Quotes drawn from this page: 48 49 51 52 53 54



“LEARN FILM MAKING SUMMER WORKSHOPS AT
PRINCETON UNIVERSITY & NEW YORK FILM
ACADEMY DIRECT YOUR OWN SHORT FILMS IN OUR
HANDS-ON INTENSIVE WORKSHOPS USING 16MM
ARRIFLEX CAMERAS. LEARN DIRECTING, STORY,
CAMERA, SOUND AND EDITING IN A TOTAL
IMMERSION COURSE DESIGNED AND TAUGHT BY
AWARD WINNING INSTRUCTORS. "CARPE DIEM".
TUITION \$4000. SUMMER WORKSHOPS START
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VILLAGE VOICE

- (1995) VILLAGE VOICE JANUARY 31ST 1995 · 1995
- P. 1

Mentioned as: "100 East 17th Street"

“Vita and Virginia: Vanessa Redgrave and Eileen Atkins star in, and Zoe Caldwell directs, this play based on the letters of Sackville West and Woolf. Union Square Theatre. 100 E 17th, 307-4100, through 2/26.”

VILLAGE VOICE

- (1995) VILLAGE VOICE JANUARY 31ST 1995 · 1995
- P. 1

Mentioned as: “100 East 17th Street”

“State of Siege, Sun: Vanessa Redgrave and Eileen Atkins host an evening of words and music to benefit the children of Sarajevo, 7. Also appearing will be Glenn Close, Stockard Channing, Mira Furlan, John Turturro, Christopher Reeve, Harvey Keitel, Simon Shaheen, Joseph Brodsky, Paul Auster, Ariel Dorfman, Susan Sontag, Tony Kushner, and Wendy Wasserstein. Union Square Theatre, 100 E 17th, 505-0700. \$”

VILLAGE VOICE

- (1995) VILLAGE VOICE JANUARY 31ST 1995 · 1995

• P. 1

Mentioned as: "100 East 17th Street"

Holmes, *100 New Yorker*, 2004, p. 37

Quotes drawn from this page: 50



then known as Newspaper Row, was once home to *The New York Herald*, *Times*, *Tribune*, *Sun*, and *World*. In Bly's day, it was the most important and most difficult to breach cluster of institutions in the country for an aspiring journalist.

.....

Roosevelt Island

In the East River from East 47th to East 96th Streets

On May 7, 1893, Bly's exposé of the insane asylum at Blackwell's Island (the former name of Roosevelt Island) appeared under her byline in *The World*. In her scheme to appear insane to the authorities and thereby to be admitted to the asylum, Bly had dressed in out-of-fashion clothes, let her hair become disheveled, and perfected a far-away look with which she wandered the streets. Having set the stage, she checked into Irene Stenard's Temporary Home for Women at 84 Second Avenue.

Pouncing on the romantic mystery (possibly fueled by Pulitzer himself), other newspapers asked their readers to help identify the young, beautiful, apparently affluent amnesiac by publishing her photo under headlines such as: "Who is this Insane Girl?" (*The Sun*) and "Mysterious Waif with the Wild Hunted Look in Her Eyes" (*The New York Times*). Though the warden at the Lunatic Asylum insisted, after the fact, that he had been suspicious all along, three doctors at Bellevue diagnosed Bly as "undoubtedly insane." She was ferried across the East River to Blackwell's Island where she spent ten days before Pulitzer sprung her from the nightmarish place.

The Octagon Tower, formerly the central structure of the Lunatic Asylum, is extant and protected as a historic site on Roosevelt Island. The Asylum, designed in 1839, was New York's first. Charles Dickens toured the hospital in 1841 during his visit to New York; he noted with familiar sadness the "long, listless, madhouse air."

.....

New York Union Square Theatre

100 East 17th Street, between Park Avenue and Irving Place
tel. (212) 505-0700

Bly delivered a series of lectures here about her record-breaking trip around the globe. As happened with many star reporters of the era, Bly's editors, once overshadowed, stopped promoting her. Bly left *The World*, feeling she was underpaid and underappreciated. She was forced to return to the staff after a failed stint as a novelist.

.....

Site of The Tombs

100 Centre Street, between Worth and Leonard Streets

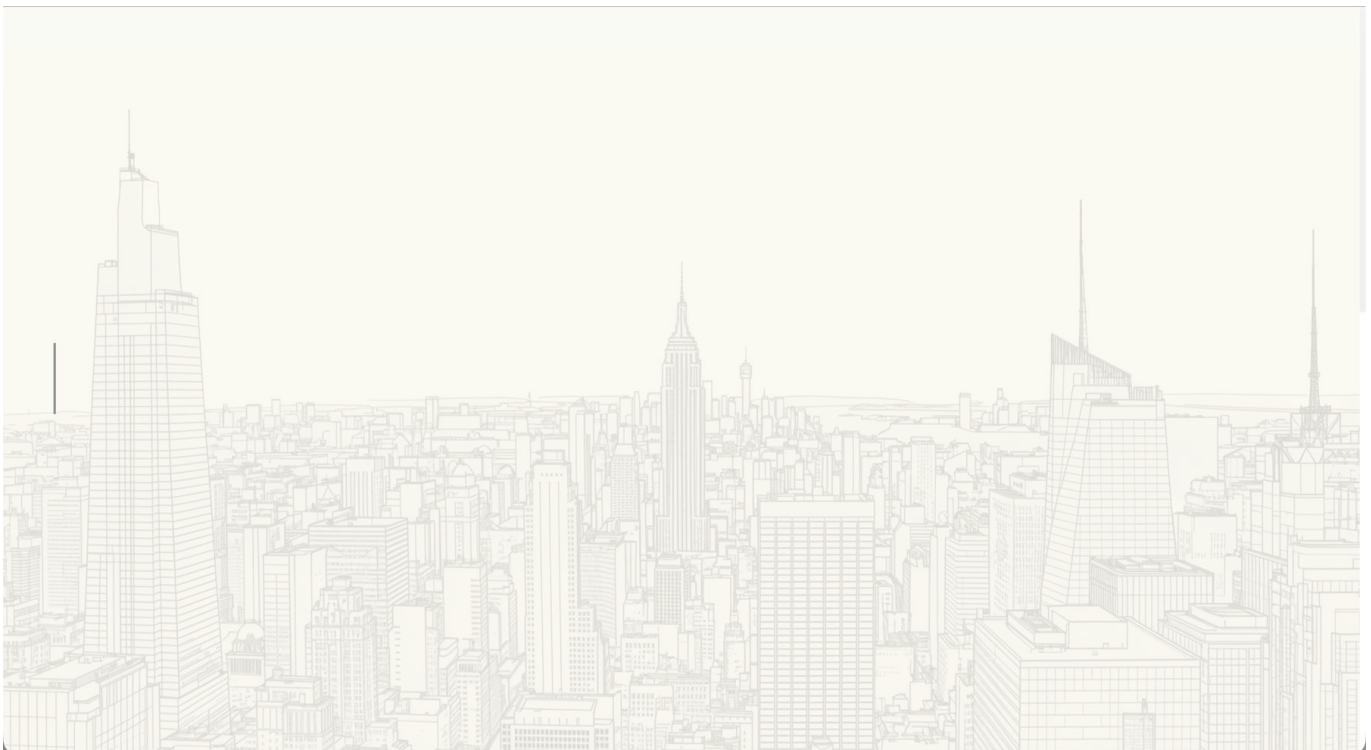
167

This site, now occupied by the Criminal Courts Building, once held the city's massive, nineteenth-century prison complex. The complex had been styled after an Egyptian

mausoleum and was known popularly as "the Tombs." Though the building that inspired the nickname is long gone, the city's central detention center is still called "the Tombs." Bly interviewed anarchist Emma Goldman here in 1893, after Goldman was imprisoned for allegedly inciting the poor to take bread "by force." Hers was the first interview with the notorious Goldman in the mainstream press. In her article published in *The World*, Bly addressed her readers: "You see her in your mind a great raw-boned creature, with short hair and bloomers, a red flag in one hand, a burning torch in the other; both feet constantly off of the ground and 'murder!' continually upon her lips." Bly encountered instead a petite woman of twenty-five with "very expressive blue-gray eyes" and a gentle

Chase, *New York The Wonder City*, 1932, p. 198

Quotes drawn from this page: 60 61 62



UNION SQUARE DISTRICT

Bounded on the south by 14th St. and on the north by 17th, between Broadway and 4th Ave.
Laid out as a park in 1832.



845.1

Union Square some years ago, was what New York's Great White Way is today. It was the amusement center of the city. Keith introduced vaudeville to New York in Union Square; Barnum's Museum was located in Union Square; The Academy of Music was on the N. E. Cor. of 14th St. & Irving Place—just a short block east of Union Square, and old Tammany Hall was just next door to the Academy. Today, Union Square is devoted to business, although East 14th St. has become quite a center for movie houses, vaudeville, dance halls,

and penny arcades. The Communists of New York make their headquarters at Union Square also.

Since the above picture was taken, the beautiful park in the center of the square is undergoing a great change. Due to excavations for subways, all the big shade trees were removed, grassy lawns and winding paths demolished, and the park generally wrecked. A stone wall of some 30 inches high has now been built around the entire area—broken only at intervals for entrances. This immense plot has been filled in with rich loam and when completed with new trees planted, new sod installed, winding pathways restored, and statues reset, Union Square will be even more inviting, and attractive than ever.

Union Square was originally a sand hill. Had it not been for the sand, Irving Place & Lexington Ave. would likely be part of Broadway today!



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Ave.

Cost \$2,500,000
252 ft. high 18 Floors



**GUARDIAN LIFE
BLDG.**

50 Union Square
N. E. Cor. 17th St. & 4th
Ave.

Cost \$2,163,000
280 ft. high 22 Floors
Rent Area 125,000 sq. ft.

235 ft. high.....21 FLOORS
Rent Area.....68,600 sq. ft.
Housing.....750
Completed.....1928
Arch.....Emery Roth
Bldr...G. Richardson Davis Co.

Rent Area...195,000 sq. ft.
Housing.....2300
Completed.....1909
Owner..Everett Investing Co.
Arch., Starrett & Van Vleck
Bldr....Geo. A. Fuller Co.
Agent.....H. Van R. Forest

Housing.....1600
Completed.....1911
Owner..Guardian Life Ins. Co.
Arch.....D'Oench & Yost
Bldr.....C. T. Wills & Co.
Manager.....H. J. Smith

Wilson, *New York in Literature*, 1947, p. 128

Quotes drawn from this page: 63



That sturdy descendant of the Knickerbockers, Gulian C. Verplanck, died at 12 East Sixteenth Street, and adjoining the College of St. Francis Xavier, less than a block distant, is the brownstone house which was the home of Bryant in the "white winter of his age." Again at 115 East Sixteenth Street Howells lodged for a time in 1900 and 1901. "I see a great deal of Mark Twain nowadays," he wrote his sister from this address, "and we have good times denouncing everything. We are old fellows, and it is pleasant to find the world so much worse than it was when we were young." And William S. Rainsford's home was at 209 East Sixteenth Street in the years when he was finding zest and profit in the labors later recorded in the *Story of a Varied Life*. George E. Woodberry, when a professor at Columbia, had bachelor apartments at 5 East Seventeenth Street. This was on the morrow of the writing and publication of the life of Poe for which he is now best remembered, and which summed up that poet's shortcomings with a severity still disputed by students of a troubled career. A three-story structure of red brick at 66 East Seventeenth Street was for a number of years the home of Edgar, nephew of Washington Irving, and an occasional sojourn of the gentle humorist when in old age he came from Sunnyside for a few days' visit to the city; and the last home of Jeannette L. Gilder, long editor of the *Critic* and an arresting, if some times amusing, figure in the literary life of the town a generation ago, was at 100 East Seventeenth Street.

At 23 Irving Place in the middle years of the last century dwelt Isaac C. Pray, brother of the gifted Malvina Pray and himself an author, actor and playwright of parts, who there wrote a biography of the elder Bennett, founder of the *Herald*, and welcomed Charles Dickens as friend and guest when in 1842 the latter visited America for the first time. Eleven numbers northward on the same side of Irving Place, still stands an old-fashioned house which was the last home of Caroline Matilda Kirkland, whose sketches of Western life, published under the pen name of Mary Clevers, gave her a secure if modest place in the literary circles of her period. At 57 Irving Place was long the home of William Conant Church, editor of the *Army and Navy Journal*, who there wrote his life of Ericsson and other books. Two doors removed on the same side of the way William Sidney

Porter had his lodgings during his most productive years as an author, finding in the neighborhood the background for some of his most diverting tales.

Brainard, *Who's Who In New York City and State*, 1911, p. 378

Quotes drawn from this page: 64



sas State Capitol, Little Rock; gen. plan and Library Univ. of Texas; Industrial Art Sch., Trenton, N. J. and Essex Co. Court House, Newark, N. J., and many other bld'gs, public, private and ecclesiastical. Mem. and one of founders Architectural League; past pres. Am. Inst. of Architects; Hon. corr. mem. Royal Inst. British Architects; Royal Inst. of Architects (Canada); University of Liverpool Architectural Soc.; mem. Sons of Revolution; academical member National Acad. Design; was member Jury of Fine Arts, World's Columbian Exp'n, Chicago, 1893, and Nat. Jury for Architecture at Paris Exp'n, 1900, mem. jury for selection of design for reconstruction of West Point Mil. Acad. App't'd by Pres. Roosevelt mem. Council of the Fine Arts, and by Pres. Taft mem. Nat. Comm'n of Fine Arts. Clubs: Century, Union, Lawyers, Republican (N. Y. City), Cosmos (Washington), Minnesota (St. Paul), St. Louis (St. Louis). Residence: 45 E. 78th St., N. Y. City, and Ridgefield, Conn. Address: 11 E. 24th St., N. Y. City.

GILBERT, Charles Benajah:

Author, lecturer; b. Wilton, Conn., Mar. 9, 1855; s. Benajah and Fannie M. (Keeler) Gilbert; grad. Williams Coll., 1876; m. Oshkosh, Wis., July 8, 1885, Jennie Weed. Successively prin. high schs. in several cities; sup't of schs. St. Paul, Minn.; Newark, N. J.; Rochester, N. Y.; editor-in-chief Ed'n Dep't. D. Appleton & Co., publishers. Author and editor (in collaboration): Stepping Stones to Literature (8 vols.), Stories of Heroes (8 vols.) and 3 in preparation, A Graded List of Poems (1 vol.), Poems by Grades (2 vols.), author (in collaboration) Guide Books to English (2 vols.), The Rational Word Book, The Gilbert Work Book, The Gleason Arithmetics (3 vols.). Author: The School and Its Life. Mem. A.A.A.S., Nat. Ed'n. Ass'n, Nat. Council of Ed'n. Clubs: University, City, Chi Psi, University (Boston), Cosmos (Washington). Residence: 23 King St., Englewood, N. J. Address: 66—5th Av., N. Y. City.

GILBERT, Charles Pierrepont H.:

Architect; b. N. Y. City, Aug. 29, 1861; s. Loring and Carolyn C. (Stebler) Gilbert; descendant of John Gilbert (second son of Giles Gilbert of Bridgewater, Somersetshire, England), who came to America and settled at Taunton, Mass., 1634, and was in command of troops who fought against the Indians; took special college courses in civil engineering and architecture, and studied painting, sculpture and fine arts under noted artists; m. Sept. 14, 1896, Florence Cecil Moss. Since 1896 has designed hotels, offices and bank buildings, churches, railroad stations, factories and business buildings, and many of most prominent private residences in the city and suburbs; director and stockholder in several mfg. concerns. Fellow Am. Inst. of Architects; mem. Architectural League, Fine Arts Soc., Municipal Arts Soc., Sons of Revolution, Soc. of Colonial Wars, Soc. War of 1812, New England Soc., Chamber of Commerce; charter mem. and one of founders of Squadron A, Cavalry, N. G. N. Y. Clubs: Metropolitan, Racquet, Lawyers, Riding, Union League, National Arts. Residence: 33 Riverside Drive. Address: Townsend Bld'g, N. Y. City.

GILBERT, Frank Birby:

Lawyer, librarian; b. Bainbridge, N. Y., Mar. 10, 1867; s. Don A. and Amelia H. (Birby) Gilbert; grad. Bainbridge Acad. 1885, Hamilton Coll., A.B., 1889; m. Bainbridge, N. Y., Oct. 9, 1895, Frances Prefot. Admitted to bar, Nov., 1891; ass't Statutory Revision Comm'n, 1892-1901; att'y in legislative bill drafting dep't. app't'd by Speaker of Assembly and pres. of Senate, 1901-05; now State Law Librarian, app't'd Jan. 10, 1906. Editor Am. Elec. Cases, and Street Railway Cases (Matthew Bender & Co.). Compiler Gilbert's Annotated Code of Civil Procedure, Town and Country Officers Manual; The Law of Domestic Relations. Co-editor (with Robert C. Cummings) The General Laws and Revised Statutes of the State of New York (4 vols.). Mem. Chi Psi fraternity (Hamilton Coll., Alpha Phi). Clubs: University (Albany), Island Golf (Troy). Address: State Law Library, Albany, N. Y.

GILBERT, Walter Rutherford:

Life insurance manager; b. Brooklyn, Oct. 11, 1872; ed. in private schools of N. Y. City. Entered home office of Mutual Life Ins. Co. of N. Y. at age of 15; gen. agent of that company for Connecticut, with office at New Haven, 1896-99; executive special agent for company, 1899-1903; mgt'r for Northeastern Ohio with office at Cleveland, 1903-07; Sept. 1, 1907, to May, 1908, of firm of Bloodgood & Gilbert, real estate and ins. brokers, N. Y. City; May 25, 1908, appointed manager of Mutual Life of N. Y. for Western N. Y. with headquarters at Buffalo, N. Y. Address: Mutual Life Building, Buffalo, N. Y.

GILBERT, William Morris:

Clergyman; b. Geneva, N. Y., Mar. 22, 1822; s. Morris J. and Eliza (Simonds) Gilbert; grad. Union Coll., B.A., 1842, Cambridge Episcopal Theol. Sch., B.D., 1853; m. Philadelphia, Oct. 10, 1852, Frances, d. Dr. John B. Chapin, sup't Pa. Hosp. for Insane, West Philadelphia; children: William Morris, Jr., b. 1854, Harriet Elizabeth, b. 1900, Frances, b. 1902. Rector Grace Ch., Carthage, N. Y., 1852-94; ass't minister, Grace Ch., Baltimore, 1894-96; rector St. Paul's Ch., Yonkers, N. Y., since 1896. Mem. Psi Upsilon fraternity. Address: Yonkers, N. Y.

GILBERT, William Wallace:

Lieut.-col., U. S. A. (retired); b. N. Y. City, Mar. 2, 1840; s. Joseph G. and Ruth Wallace) Gilbert; grad. Univ. of Rochester, A.B., 1861, A.M., 1864; m. Utica, N. Y., April 5, 1870, Mary E. Chapman. App't'd 1st lieut. 18th Inf., May 14, 1861; regimental adjutant from Aug. 1, 1861, to July 7, 1864; capt., July 7, 1864; resigned, Jan. 9, 1866; served through the Civil War. Was instr. Latin and Greek, Univ. of Rochester, 1867-68; U. S. comm'r, Rochester, N. Y., 1868-69; app't'd Major, U. S. A., Nov. 4, 1893; served through Spanish War; retired, 1904; promoted to lieut.-col., U. S. A., retired April 23, 1904. Republican. Baptist. Mem. Delta Psi fraternity, Soc. of Phi Beta Kappa, Military Order of Loyal Legion of U. S., G. A. R. Clubs: Army and Navy (Washington), University (Rochester), Rochester Athletic. Address: 30 Arnold Park, Rochester, N. Y.

GILBERT, Jeannette Leonard:

Journalist; b. Flushing, N. Y., Oct. 3, 1869; d. Rev. William H. and Jane (Nutt)

